

Iran War Risk

Pillar Report

Middle East Conflict Risk — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

Originally written June 19, 2026; scores committed by me June 19, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026, and again as a full weekly refresh on August 8, 2026 (P cut at 1mo/3mo, 24/31/41/56/77 → 20/28/41/56/77, committed and stamped by Alex, last COMMITTED baseline). The Aug 16-22 gap saw four abandoned drafts: Aug 17 (held flat), Aug 18 (cut to 17/25/38/54/76), Aug 20 (cut to 16/24/38/54/76, left for manual review over a UAE missile claim), and Aug 21 (a session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers — 2 of 6 reports touched, no render/selfcheck/archive/commit — before stopping). None were rendered, archived, or committed. An Aug 22 morning catch-up cycle (score set **2026-08-22_draft**) independently re-verified the gap via four parallel primary-source research passes, then adversarially fact-checked the load-bearing new claims before delivery — a step that caught a real error (see below) — and cut P to 14/22/38/54/76, delivered as a draft flagged for manual review. **Correction #1 (confirmed accurate):** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only, Iran denies and calls it a possible "false flag") and was NOT the first direct attack on the UAE as prior drafts framed it — UAE was hit by a missile/drone barrage Apr 1-8 and again at its Fujairah port May 4, both Iran-attributed by UAE's own government and predating Aug 18; that "novel escalation vector" framing is retired. **Correction #2 (a genuine miss, caught on adversarial re-check):** that draft initially described a fatal strike on the bulker Minoan Dignity (chief engineer killed, Aug 17-18) as "the first confirmed fatality" in the Hormuz tanker campaign — that is FALSE; it is one of a cumulative toll of seafarer deaths since the campaign began late February 2026 this report never previously surfaced or scored on. The Iranian vessel seizure (tanker Amara, held near Qeshm Island since Aug 17, first since June 22) IS confirmed accurate. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-22_draft2) is a separate, later-in-the-day FULL WEEKLY refresh** — the first deep multi-source dive since Aug 8 — that independently re-researched the pillar and ran a second, dedicated adversarial-verification pass specifically re-checking (a) whether the casualty-toll figure holds up and (b) whether anything was missed Aug 19-22. It holds up, but softer than a clean number: cross-checking Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (18 total), a mid-July gCaptain snapshot ("at least 15"), and IMO's own incident tracker (19 seafarer deaths, but scoped to the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly) puts the honest range at **15-19 cumulative deaths (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**, not a flat "18th death" — that softened framing is carried everywhere below. A UAE missile-attack claim the adversarial pass initially flagged as a possible miss turned out, on reconciliation, to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline, not a second incident. No new kinetic incident was found Aug 19-22. **P HELD FLAT this cycle at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as draft at delivery (full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from auto-stamp), then reviewed and COMMITTED BY ALEX on August 23** after independent re-verification of the math and the research trail; see My Decision below. A daily catch-up draft dated August 28, 2026 (score set **2026-08-28_draft**) re-checked two more Hormuz tanker incidents and a single-source Iran-Oman revenue-sharing claim, holding P flat — but that draft was never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed, and is treated as abandoned/superseded, the same discipline this report has applied to every other interrupted session (Aug 17, 18, 20, and 21). **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-29_draft) is a NEW, independent FULL WEEKLY refresh** against the last committed baseline (2026-08-22_draft2) — the first cycle in several weeks to surface a genuinely two-sided evidence ledger: a confirmed, crypto-specific sanctions escalation (the Aug 24 "Operation Economic Outcast" package, the first Iran sanctions action to explicitly name digital assets as a sanctionable sector and list 30 on-chain addresses, confirmed via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov) against a confirmed de-escalation upgrade (Oman's own Foreign Ministry, not just Iran, co-confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor Aug 25, confirmed via direct fetch of fm.gov.om). The two roughly offset, alongside a first-of-the-crisis Hormuz transit uptick and a second straight weekly Brent decline on the bull side, and two more tanker incidents plus a firmer casualty count on the bear side. **P HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as a draft, not auto-stamped**, because this is a full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size (here, zero). See My Decision below. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-31_draft) is a light daily catch-up** covering the Aug 29-31 gap: on Aug 30, US forces struck IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Iran's Larak Island — the first US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29 — directly firing this pillar's own pre-declared flip line ("a

resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper"). Iran retaliated with ballistic missiles on two US-linked Jordan airbases hours later; Jordan intercepted 8 missiles; no confirmed US casualty. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 9/17/34/51/75** (from 14/22/38/54/76), front-loaded and held under 8 points per window. This is a light daily touch, not a full weekly refresh, no window moved >8 points, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip vs. the last stamped set — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-01_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Aug 31-Sept 1: escalation continued into a second day — a THIRD Hormuz tanker hit (the VLCC Senegal Prosperity, Aug 31), a disputed Iranian claim of a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base (UAE MoD denies the target claim but confirms it intercepted an Iranian drone over its waters), and Trump on-record Aug 31 still weighing further strikes on Iran. **P RE-RATED DOWN again, more modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75** (from 9/17/34/51/75) — no window moved more than 2 points, well under the 8-point auto-stamp threshold. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority** — the new last COMMITTED baseline. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-02_draft) is a further light daily catch-up that turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since Aug 30:** CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — roughly 50x the scale of the single Aug 30 Larak strike — including, for the first time in this war, direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a new "tanker for tanker" policy. A US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Kuhestak, Hormozgan (4+ dead per the Hormozgan governor's office, including a 4-year-old, 60+ injured) — flagged here as SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact level (Iranian state/local authorities; CENTCOM has neither confirmed nor denied it), so it does not by itself move P, but it is the reported trigger for Iran's response: coordinated IRGC ballistic-missile/drone strikes Sept 2 on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — larger in scale than the single-state Aug 30-31 Jordan strike, but all four are repeat targets, so the "widening to a further NEW state" flip-line clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN sharply to 1/9/27/47/74** (from 7/15/32/50/75), front-loaded and kept under 8 points per window. **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026,** retroactively, under Alex's Sept 3 widened delegated daily auto-stamp policy: a call-band flip and the size of a move are no longer disqualifying on their own. The wedding-casualty fact was correctly kept single-narrative-sourced and never used to move P, and nothing about the sourcing or the research itself changed — only the stamping threshold did. This remains the last TRUE committed baseline: 1/9/27/47/74. **Sept 3:** Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Kuwait and UAE — both repeat targets, no US-manned facility hit, widening clause does not fire. **P HELD FLAT. Sept 5, light daily catch-up (2026-09-05_draft):** held flat again — the Reuters weapons-expert corroboration of the Sept 1 wedding strike resolves attribution of an already-priced event, not new escalation; a Sept 5 Iranian-media report of a US strike on the tanker STARK 1 near Kharg Island is single-narrative and not used to move P. **CORRECTION:** that cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED," but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced to committed — a bug in that session, flagged here, not corrected retroactively. **Sept 5, FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2), this version:** independently re-verified via WebSearch — the STARK 1 incident is real and developing (Iran International separately obtained video of US radio warnings, and AP itself frames it as an Iranian accusation, not a confirmed fact) but CENTCOM has still not confirmed or denied it, so per the sufficiency rule it is NOT used to move P. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fired this week. **HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy — left for manual review, and COMMITTED BY ALEX September 5, 2026. Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft):** CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release now confirms the Sept 5 tanker strike this report had withheld pending confirmation — and reveals it was materially more serious than known: THREE Iranian tankers (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) struck in retaliation for an unprovoked IRGC ballistic-missile attack on two US Navy warships, both of which evaded. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73** — no window moved more than 2 points, no flip-line clause independently fires (no confirmed US casualty, no widening to a new state, Brent short of \$100), and the master call band held Neutral → Neutral. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-08_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 6-8: the new fact is Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei's on-record Sept 6-7 announcement (state TV, Press TV, Tehran Times) that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning any vessel that enters — corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu, GlobalSecurity.org) but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed ("further details... yet to be announced" per Al Jazeera's Sept 7 explainer). No flip-line clause fires (DCAS still 18, Brent ~\$97.29 Sept 7, no new state). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from 1/8/25/45/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-09_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 8-9: CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship") confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers on Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman) and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days, corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org); both Iranian missile attempts were evaded, no US personnel harmed. Separately, Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24 (CNBC, ABC News; ~\$100.44, +2.57%) — a single-day intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line threshold, so it does not independently fire that clause, but it is the

closest this cycle has come to the flip line. No flip-line clause fires (no US casualty, no new state, only an intraday Brent cross). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-10_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 9-10: two new dated facts. CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq air base — 18 intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org, Jordan's own military). Jordan is a repeat target, so the widening clause does not fire, and both sides confirm no casualties, so the US-casualty clause does not fire either. Separately, Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz — confirmed by 5+ outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, SCMP, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail), but the same Houthi/Yemen actor already priced, and no strait closure has actually been executed, so this does not independently fire a clause either. Brent has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session (CNBC: above \$101 Sept 9; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but still short of a clean sustained-close call. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral). **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-11_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 10-11: this pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause FIRES on a third consecutive session — Brent closed Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday, its highest since May 19, with WTI closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent) — alongside fuller reporting of Iran's Sept 9 shipping wave: 10 vessels attacked near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), the largest declared wave of the war, with at least one seafarer killed and one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. No window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar on every scored fact, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip anywhere. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-12_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 11-12: Houthi forces, having seized Mocha Sept 10, swept the rest of Yemen's Red Sea coastline by Sept 11 — capturing the final government-held coastal towns (Dhubab, Murad) and Houthi naval forces seizing Mayyun (Perim) Island in the Bab al-Mandeb strait itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island — a materially more severe status (actual control of a second global chokepoint's own islands) than the Sept 10 baseline's "closing in" characterization, confirmed by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Separately, UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 confirms four projectiles struck two more vessels near Khasab, Oman Sept 10, one set afire (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborating); an IRGC claim of a Saldrone strike is single-source and not used to move P. Yemen is an existing theater, so the widening clause does not fire; no US casualty, so that clause doesn't either — this is a severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment, not a fresh clause firing. **P RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from 1/4/20/40/71) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **LATER THE SAME DAY (Sept 12): a separate FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12_draft2), the first full-weekly-depth research dive since the Sept 5 full weekly refresh, ran four parallel adversarial research passes across all four qualitative pillars against the 2026-09-12_draft committed baseline (1/2/18/38/70).** One new dated fact clears the sufficiency bar: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route, a NEW target distinct from the already-logged Sept 8 Aramco/Jazan refinery strikes — was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory on Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement/confirmation issued Sept 11). PRIMARY: Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request; corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com) with satellite imagery of fire/smoke at the pumping stations, plus Iraq's own PM ordering a probe, dismissing the Maysan operations commander, and closing the Shalamchah border crossing. No group has claimed responsibility; President Trump, in Dublin, said Iran was "probably" responsible — a single, hedged, unconfirmed remark, logged as such, NOT as established fact (the Saudi MFA statement itself attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state). Neither flip-line clause fires: the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province — escalation within an existing theater, not a new one), and the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (no confirmed US military casualty found); the sustained-Brent->\$100 clause continues to hold (~\$104.61 Sept 12, same as the morning baseline) as persistence, not a fresh trigger. Also logged, not scored: Trump's own account that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen (single-source as to substance, consistent with the already-logged MBS-refused-strikes counterweight), and the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept

12, all members plus Saudi Arabia/Iran/UAE) urging "maximum restraint" over the escalation — a mild long-horizon diplomatic data point relevant only to the 1yr/3yr framing. The Mayyun Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure (Sept 10-11) was independently re-verified as still holding, not disputed (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge). Sized small given a single infrastructure strike with no widening and no US casualty: **P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held, 1mo held at the near-floor 1. **WEEKLY REFRESH — left as DRAFT for Alex's manual review, full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size.** Committed by Alex; Sept 13-14 light daily catch-ups held flat with nothing new clearing the sufficiency bar, AUTO-STAMPED. **Sept 16 (score set 2026-09-16_draft):** RE-RATED DOWN on the 6/12/36mo windows to 1/1/14/33/66 (from 1/1/18/38/70) — the IAEA Board of Governors voted Sept 9 to refer Iran's nuclear file to the UN Security Council, and 130 Iranian lawmakers signed a Sept 12-13 statement calling for NPT withdrawal, with a hardline MP describing an emergency bill being drafted (RFE/RL, Tehran Times, Mehr News); Pezeshkian's public no-nuclear-weapons stance and the Foreign Ministry's "still being prepared" framing kept the move modest. AUTO-STAMPED, the last TRUE committed baseline. **THIS VERSION (Sept 17, score set 2026-09-17_draft) HOLDS FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66** — re-checked, no new dated development beyond the Sept 9 IAEA referral and the Sept 12-13 NPT statement already priced; Pezeshkian's and the Foreign Ministry's positions are unchanged. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. See My Decision below.

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 20% OF MY THESIS (EQUAL, 1/5)

Written June 19, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified September 17, 2026 — LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-17_draft (P **HELD FLAT** at 1/1/14/33/66). Re-checked; no new dated development beyond the Pezeshkian's public no-nuclear-weapons stance and the Foreign Ministry's "still being prepared" framing on the withdrawal bill are unchanged, already-priced facts, re-confirmed via independent re-search 6/12/36mo) · Not Financial Advice

The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts

June column committed by me June 19, 2026 · Aug 8 (cut at 1mo/3mo, full weekly refresh) committed and stamped by Alex · Aug 9-16 are light daily touches, all held flat (no cycle ran Aug 15) · Aug 17-21 drafted but never delivered as a draft at delivery (full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from auto-stamp) and **COMMITTED BY ALEX August 23, 2026**. An Aug 28 daily catch-up draft held P flat but was never rendered/selfchecked/archived/committed — (full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from auto-stamp) pending Alex's manual review — that draft is now superseded and collapses out of this table per house rules on committed sets. **Aug 31 (2026-08-31_draft)** was a US-linked Jordan airstrikes fired this pillar's own pre-declared downside flip line — P cut to 9/17/34/51/75, AUTO-STAMPED. **Sept 1 (2026-09-01_draft)** was a further light daily catch-up covering Aug 31-Sept 1: escalation continued **02_draft** covers **Sept 1-2**: the conflict escalated materially — CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iran (~50x the scale of the Aug 30 strike), including the war's first direct US strikes on Iranian government coordinated strikes on FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait — all repeat targets, so the widening clause does not fire). **P RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74** — front-loaded, kept under 8 points per win action, and the master call band flip Mild Bull → Neutral); **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026** once Alex widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy so a call-band flip and move size no longer withhold the **Sept 5 (2026-09-05_draft)** held flat again; that cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED," but config/scores.json's status was never actually advanced — flagged as a correction, not itself edited. **Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh** unconfirmed by CENTCOM, not used to move P); categorically excluded from daily auto-stamp authority, so it went to manual review and is **COMMITTED BY ALEX September 5, 2026**. **Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft)** re-rates P down modestly again to 1/6/23/43/72: CENTCOM's own press release confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers S corroborated by 5+ independent outlets — and Brent crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24, a single-day cross short of this pillar's sustained-\$100 flip line. No window moved more than 1 point, master call **catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft)** re-rates P down modestly again to 1/5/22/42/72: the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq air base in retaliation for the Sept 8 tanker strike (18 intercepted, no casualties), and already priced; Brent traded above \$100 for a second straight session, still short of a sustained close. No window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause fires on a third consecutive session (Brent closed above \$107 Thursday Sept 10, highest since May 19), alongside fuller reporting of Iran's 10-vessel Sept 9 Hormuz shipping **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline. **Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft)** re-rates P down, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70: Houthi forces swept the rest of Yemen al-Mandeb strait, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island — a second global chokepoint moving from "closing in on" to actual island-level control, confirmed by 6+ independent outlets; separately UKMTO confirms two more vessels routine daily grind — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline. **Sept 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12_draft2)** independently re-researched the week via four parallel actions (Petroline) was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory Sept 10 (Saudi MFA-confirmed Sept 11, 6+ independent outlets), sponsorship undetermined (Trump's "probably Iran" is a single hedged remark, not used as fact); neither the 1/2/18/38/70). **LEFT AS DRAFT — full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size — awaiting Alex's manual review**. Committed by Alex; Sept 13-14 held flat lawmaker NPT-withdrawal statement — AUTO-STAMPED, the last TRUE committed baseline. **Sept 17 (2026-09-17_draft, this version)** HOLDS FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66 — no new dated development found — AUTO-STAMPED per de

WINDOW	JUN	...	8/22 (COMMITTED)	8/31 (COMMITTED)	9/1 (COMMITTED)	9/2 (COMMITTED)	9/5 D2 (COMMITTED)	9/6 (COMMITTED)	9/8 (COMMITTED)	9/9	9/10	9/11 (COMMITTED)	9/12 (COMMITTED)
1 month	50	...	14	9	7	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
3 months	55	...	22	17	15	9	9	8	7	6	5	4	2
6 months	62	...	38	34	32	27	27	25	24	23	22	20	1
1 year	75	...	54	51	50	47	47	45	44	43	42	40	3

P — the odds this is *good for crypto* by then. **THIS CYCLE (Sept 14, LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-15_draft): RE-RATED DOWN to 1/1/18/38/70** (from the Sept 13-committed 3/3/18/38/70). **Sunday September 13:** "It has been decided to postpone to a later date the regional meeting that was to be held on Monday in Salalah, in order to create conditions conducive to a constructive dialogue" (Sept 13-14). And the absence of Gulf-Arab buy-in is the substance, not the scheduling: **Bahrain explicitly ruled out attending, no GCC state had confirmed participation, and the UAE had not** requested the postponement citing the Yemen war and calls that a pretext — **SINGLE-PARTY SOURCED to Iranian officials, reported here but not relied on to move P**. A second dated fact: **reopening of the Strait of Hormuz**" (Tehran Times / Mehr — Iranian state media quoting Iran's own foreign minister, primary for Iran's stated position; echoed Sept 14 by Eurasia Review and **November**) and WTI **\$102.34 (+2.3%)**. **A note on what was checked and rejected:** research this cycle surfaced drone strikes on Salalah and Duqm ports; those are dated **March 1, 3 and 11** — point above the Sept 12 level — the Iran-Oman bilateral lane framework, charts drawn and draft joint statement prepared, survives the postponement and Oman's FM publicly recommitted to

Prior cycle (Sept 12 daily, score set 2026-09-12_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70 (from the Sept 11-committed 1/4/20/40/71). **BEARISH and NEW: a second global**
Mocha Sept 10 (logged in the Sept 10 baseline as "closing in" on Bab al-Mandeb), continued an offensive that by Sept 11 captured Dhubab and Murad — the final coastal towns held by the in
coastline; Houthis naval forces separately seized Mayyun (Perim) Island inside the Bab al-Mandeb strait itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island. This is confirmed by 6+ independent out
status the Sept 10 cycle priced — actual control of strait-controlling islands in a second global oil chokepoint distinct from Hormuz, not merely an approach to one. Saudi Crown Prince Moham
support offered instead) — a genuine US-restraint data point, logged as an honest counterweight. Per this pillar's own flip-line definitions, Yemen/the Houthis are an existing theater (not a fun
does not fire either — this is a continuation/severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment (the direct-US-strikes and sustained-Brent clauses both fired in prior cycles), not a fresh
maritime security authority — primary source) confirms four unidentified projectiles struck two vessels roughly 4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire; corroborated by 3+ independent
have separately struck a US Navy Saildrone Explorer-type unmanned vessel near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM confirmation found. Brent held near/above \$104 for a fifth consecutive
already fired Sept 10-11, not a fresh trigger. **P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 4→2, 6mo 20→18, 12mo 40→38, 36mo 71→70.** A second chokepoint moving under a
than recent 1-point touches but still restrained since no flip-line newly fires — the sourcing clears the primary-plus-multi-outlet bar (UKMTO's own warning, not a single outlet, for the vessel s
status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."

[illegible]

and "threatening" control, not as having executed a blockade — so it does not independently fire a flip-line clause either. Separately, Brent crude has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second day (Thursday Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's single-day intraday cross, but still short of a clean multi-session "sustained" call by this pillar's own conservative standard; flagged as the close of a Net: a repeat-pattern regional strike plus a new-but-same-actor Yemen/Red Sea territorial escalation, both intensifying the trend already priced without crossing any flip-line threshold. **P RE-FIRE** (a repeat regional strike and a same-theater territorial shift do not move the multi-year thesis). No window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the **Net** is **weighted** — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior to this cycle (Sept 9, score set 2026-09-09_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72 (from the Sept 8-committed 1/7/24/44/73). **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers on Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC** independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own release — clears the sufficiency bar. CENTCOM confirms both Iranian missile attacks this is a repeat pattern (Gulf of Oman, Kharg Island are both existing theater), not a widening to a further new state. Separately, Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday today (Sept 9) for the first time since 2011, and ABC News, trading ~\$100.44, +2.57% — but this is a single-day intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line threshold, so it does not independently fire that clause (already logged in the Sept 8 baseline as a not-yet-executed threat) remains in the same state — coverage today still describes boundaries as unspecified/forthcoming, so it is not re-scored a flip-line event, sized consistently with those cycles' modest per-cycle cuts. **P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo 7→6, 6mo 24→23, 12mo 44→43, 36mo 72→71** — the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED**

Prior to this cycle (Sept 8, score set 2026-09-08_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73 (from the Sept 6-committed 1/8/25/45/73). BEARISH and NEW: Iran's SNS will declare, "in the coming days," a new "restricted zone" beginning at the US Navy's blockade line and extending into the Persian Gulf, with any vessel entering it placed on Iran's list of vessels to be targeted. This was corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) reporting the same on-record statement — clearing the sufficiency of the 7 explainer states "further details, including the precise boundaries, have yet to be announced," and no zone had actually been declared as of this cycle's research cutoff. Consistent with this pattern of "strikes" comment), this is sized as a small continuation-of-escalation cut, not a flip-line event: DCAS US KIA remains 18 (unchanged since Sept 4), no widening to a further new state, and Brent Crude 192 (Sept 7) blockade count of 92 vessels redirected / 3 disabled / 2 boarded (up from Day 190's 87/3/2 on Sept 3) is a continuation of the already-priced blockade-enforcement trend, not seen in the temporary 7-mile corridor from late August remains the operative arrangement). **P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo 8-7, 6mo 25-24, 12mo 45-44** (moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the run rule stamped)."

Prior to this cycle (Sept 6 light daily catch-up, score set 2026-09-06_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73 (from the Sept 5-committed 1/9/27/47/74). **BEARISH a** **is more serious than known.** CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil, corroborated by Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC, and 5+ other independent outlets) states US (permanently disabled near Jask), and M/T Kylo (completely destroyed in the Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (an aircraft carrier and CENTCOM's commander: "If you shoot at two of our ships, we will impose an even higher economic cost — taking out three of yours." This clears the sufficiency bar the Sept 5 baseline explicitly now primary-sourced and multiply corroborated, and it reveals a materially more serious escalation than a quiet single-tanker interdiction: a direct, unprovoked IRGC missile attack on US Navy US naval drone in the Strait of Hormuz (Al Jazeera's live blog, Euronews) are IRGC's own claims only — not yet US-confirmed, so per the sufficiency rule they are NOT independently used to still 18 as of Sept 4, unchanged from the standing count), no widening to a further new state (Kharg Island, Jask, and the Gulf of Oman are all existing theater), and Brent closed ~\$96/bbl Friday escalation/severity-upgrade to an already-known event, not a fresh flip-line shock, and kept small: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. This is a master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed**

Prior to this cycle: P was RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74 (Sept 2, committed Sept 3, then HELD FLAT through Sept 3's Kuwait/UAE repeat-target strikes and the Sept 5 full weekly 7/15/32/50/75) — researched Sept 2, **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026** under Alex's widened daily auto-stamp policy. **BEARISH and CONFIRMED, the load-bearing n** CENTCOM confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iran Sept 1-2 — IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, communications sites, and anti-ship cruise-missile/drone lau For the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms), under a newly reported Trump-approved "tanker for tanker" policy, a marked shift from the p to ~\$91-92, still short of the \$100 flip line. A US strike on Kuestak, Sirik County, Hormozgan (near the Strait) reportedly hit a wedding party: the Hormozgan governor's office named 4 of at le **NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact level:** the casualty claim originates with Iranian state and local authorities, and CENTCOM's Cmdr. Tim Hawkins told CBS News the US has neither co report the claim (wide pickup of a single-narrative core fact is not the same as multi-sourcing the fact itself). It is reported here as context for what it triggered: Iran's IRGC launched coordinate Kuwait — a materially larger, four-country retaliation versus the single-state Jordan strike Aug 30-31. But all four are REPEAT targets already struck earlier in this war (Jordan: Jul 28 and Aug 30 "widening to a FURTHER NEW state with confirmed attribution" flip-line clause does NOT fire. Most projectiles were intercepted (Jordan: roughly 10 of 25 intercepted, 3 landed with no reports) found as of this run — so neither the casualty clause nor the widening clause independently fires either. The already-fired (Aug 30) "resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" clause is sir threatening larger future action: President Trump threatened a "significantly larger response" if Iran retaliates further; an unnamed senior Iranian military source told press Tehran's response w kept under the 8-point/window auto-stamp threshold: 1mo 7→1, 3mo 15→9, 6mo 32→27, 12mo 50→47, 36mo 75→74. **Originally left as draft Sept 2, not auto-stamped, for three reasons:** sourced even though widely reported, so confidence in today's sizing was lower than for a cleanly multi-sourced primary event; (2) the scale jump (nearly 100 targets, first-ever direct tanker st threats of much larger responses ahead raised the cost of a miscalibrated cut. It also independently flipped the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band (Mild Bull → Neutral) versus th **reviewed this cycle and widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy: a call-band flip and move size are no longer disqualifying by themselves.** The underlying sourcing and sufficient changed. **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026.** See My Decision below for the full reasoning.

Prior to this cycle (Sept 1 light daily catch-up): P was RE-RATED DOWN to 7/15/32/50/75 (from the Aug 31-committed 9/17/34/51/75) — AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. (see below) was explicitly sized on the assumption that "one resumed-strike night is not yet a sustained new campaign" — that assumption is undercut by what happened next. A THIRD Hormuz miles northeast of Khasab, Oman, during outbound transit — hit on the port side, engine room, and ballast tank; no casualties, no environmental impact reported; UKMTO-logged. This followed on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base near Dubai; the UAE Ministry of Defense explicitly DENIED that Al Minhad was targeted, while separately confirming its air force intercepted an Iranian drone incursion, a genuine (if unconfirmed-as-a-hit) attempt to widen beyond the repeat-target Jordan pattern. Jordan was struck again Aug 30-31, but as a repeat target (already struck Jul 28), not on Iran, calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo — on-record, multi-source) — explicitly not signaling de-escalation. Brent crude continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% second straight cycle of gains on this news thread. No new confirmed US casualty, and no confirmed hit on UAE territory (UAE denies), so this does NOT independently fire a fresh flip-line claim cleanly. This is a continuation/erosion of the "single incident" framing, not a fresh shock of comparable size to the Aug 30-31 cut itself — hence the small move, well under the 8-point auto-stop. Jazeera, Breitbart, Yahoo, Jerusalem Post, ABC News, Seatrade Maritime, Iran International, and UKMTO. Prior to this, on Aug 30 US forces struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Larak Island. Hawkins confirmed on the record, corroborated by 20+ independent outlets (Bloomberg, CNBC, NBC News, Reuters, Newsweek, ABC News, Al Jazeera, Fox News, RFE/RL, Epoch Times, Daily Caller) ending the ~28-30-consecutive-clean-night streak the Aug 29 baseline explicitly cited as part of its bullish case, and it directly fired this pillar's own pre-declared downside flip line ("a resumed trigger firing exactly as written. IRGC confirmed Iranian soldiers/civilians killed or wounded at Larak (no precise toll given) and retaliated hours later, into Aug 31, with ballistic missiles at two U.S. damage" to base infrastructure — unconfirmed by the US or Jordan beyond the interception, so logged as Iran-sourced, not scored as fact. That cut was front-loaded and held under 8 points 22—17, 6mo 38—34, 12mo 54—51 and 36mo 76—75. Prior to that, the Aug 29 full weekly refresh had held P flat at 14/22/38/54/76 on a genuinely two-sided ledger: **BEARISH and CONFIRMED** sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Regime on Economic D-Day") and sb0614 (Bessent's remarks), plus an OFAC recent-actions entry dated 20260824 — confirmed by CryptoTimes) plus law-firm client alerts. ~60 entities/individuals/vessels were designated across Hong Kong, China, Malaysia, UAE, Singapore, and Switzerland under five sectoral determinations — 30 crypto addresses across Bitcoin, Ethereum, and TRON were listed. Unlike the sanctions this pillar tracked in prior cycles as "promised but not landed" (Bessent's rhetoric through Aug 22) Melli-Dubai designation. Two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents fired this window: Aug 24 off Oman (engine-room damage, disabled, no casualties, UKMTO) and Aug 27 (fire on board). Adm. Brad Cooper gave an on-record briefing Aug 28 (corroborated by UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire): US forces cleared Iranian sea mines from the international waters, vessels turned back and 3 disabled for evading the blockade; no oil has been exported from Iran since the blockade resumed — read as continuation/intensification of an existing posture, not a new shock. 20 dead (seafarers + port workers) across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the previously-reported 15-19 range, a slight negative confirmation, not a new shock. **BULLISH and CONFIRMED** (Oman's own government site) — a genuine upgrade, because in every prior cycle only Iran claimed a Hormuz deal and Oman had not confirmed it; now Oman's own ministry co-hosts the status project, and continuing technical talks toward a permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum." Still explicitly described as "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" separate IRGC spokesman claim (Aug 26) of an Iran-Oman revenue-sharing deal remains single-source and unconfirmed by Oman — correctly excluded from scoring, same treatment as prior cycle. France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 tanker attack above. The first quantified Hormuz transit-volume increase of the entire crisis: +30%+ week-over-week for the week of Aug 28 — 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29—42); still a small fraction (~10-15%) of the ~110-130/day (~770-910/week) pre-war baseline, but the first confirmed uptick of the cycle. ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving further away from the \$100/bbl flip line, with press explicitly framing it as "war premium unwinding" on the Hormuz project. Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the standing casualty total, not a new event) — the flip line remains unfired. No new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran found — GlobalSecurity. **new escalation and the new de-escalation roughly offset.** The pillar's own explicit upside flip line — a signed, US-accepted Hormuz deal holding a full clean week without a new attack/fatalities only (not US-accepted). Consistent with this pillar's standing discipline against chasing single-cycle mixed signals in either direction: P HELD FLAT on all five windows.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. This cycle's load-bearing fact — the Petroline pipeline drone strike — is corroborated by a primary Saudi Ministry of Foreign Affairs statement plus sufficiency bar; the single-source Trump "probably Iran" attribution is explicitly NOT used to move P. The prior cycle's load-bearing fact — the Bab al-Mandeb chokepoint seizure — remains confirmed. Khasab vessel strikes remain confirmed via UKMTO's own official warning plus 3+ independent outlets. Quality (the 0-1 input) is unchanged this cycle per house rules: 0.60/0.65/0.70/0.65/0.55.

Impact — 8 out of 10, the uniform value shared by every pillar in the equal-weight model. BTC traded at \$76,916.53 on Sept 14, firming from \$76,808.69 on Sept 13 and \$77,269.22 on Sept 12. house discipline this pillar's score is not adjusted to chase or match the tape either way. For context, BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2, down from \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 — the real, visible risk.

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated September 16, 2026 (light daily touch, P re-rated down on the 6/12/36mo windows as the nuclear track escalates alongside the shooting war)

This cycle (Sept 16): the crowd's attention today is almost entirely on the CLARITY Act vote failure, not Iran — but two real, dated escalatory facts landed this week on the nuclear track that this cycle. Lawmakers publicly pushed for NPT withdrawal on Sept 12-13. **Me:** I'm treating this as real but bounded — a parliamentary push and an institutional referral are documented facts, not a complete escalation against reading this as a fait accompli. That's why the move lands entirely on the 6/12/36mo windows (18–14, 38–33, 70–66) and not on 1mo/3mo, which were already sitting at this pillar's floor. The pipeline, the Salalah postponement, Hormuz shipping — showed nothing new this cycle, so those didn't independently move anything.

Prior cycle (Sept 12, full weekly refresh): the crowd will likely either read the Petroline pipeline strike as proof Iran is now hitting Saudi Arabia's core oil-export infrastructure directly, or dismiss it. **Me:** the honest read sits between those: a drone strike launched from Iraqi soil hit a NEW kind of target (Saudi Arabia's primary Hormuz-bypass export artery, not a refinery this time) for the third time. Trump's Dublin remark is a single hedged guess, not evidence, and score accordingly: the move is small (3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each) precisely because the load-bearing fact is a single infrastructure strike. Siding with either the "Iran did it" or "no proof, ignore it" framings. The BRICS restraint declaration and Trump's own account of Houthis reluctance to draw in the US are both logged honestly as context.

Prior cycle (Sept 12 daily): the crowd will likely either treat the Bab al-Mandeb island seizures as a headline-grabbing new front that should crater risk assets, or dismiss it as "just Yemen" background noise. **Me:** structural, not emotional — Iran-aligned forces now hold actual chokepoint-controlling islands in a SECOND global oil corridor, not merely "closing in" on one, and that upgrades the standing risk. The cut larger than the recent 1-point daily touches for exactly that reason, while still stopping short of treating it as a flip-line event, because it isn't one by this pillar's own pre-declared, falsifiable definition. The fact to justify a bigger move. The MBS-request-refused detail is logged honestly because it cuts the other way: the US is not chasing every escalation into a wider war.

Prior cycle (Sept 11): the crowd will read a \$108 print and a 6% up-day in Brent as the war finally repricing energy — or, watching Friday's 3% give-back on Hormuz diplomacy headlines, wave that. **Me:** sustained Brent close above \$100 — and three consecutive sessions above it, including a close above \$107, is that clause firing, not a near-miss. I said so in the two prior cycles when it hadn't fired. The confirmed US combat death since Sept 4, still no strike on a further new state, and the one death in the Sept 9 shipping wave was a merchant seafarer, not a service member. So this is a further move.

Prior cycle (Sept 10): the crowd is likely to either read the Al Azraq missile barrage as a dangerous new peak of the conflict, or wave off a Yemeni port city changing hands as background noise. **Me:** in isolation, but Jordan has now absorbed this kind of strike repeatedly since Jul 28, and both CENTCOM and Jordan's own military confirm no casualties this time either — a repeat-pattern event. This pillar has tracked in the Red Sea/Bab al-Mandeb theater for months, so it doesn't independently widen the war, but "closing in on" a second global chokepoint is a genuine structural development. This session is the more important tell than either strike — not yet a sustained close, but the clearest signal yet that markets are pricing this as durable rather than a one-day spike. Re-rating down modestly.

Prior cycle (Sept 9): the crowd is likely to either read Brent's intraday \$100 cross as confirmation the flip line has effectively fired, or dismiss the 5-tanker CENTCOM strike as "more of the same" noise. **Me:** the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but it is explicitly not the same thing as a sustained close above \$100, which is what this pillar's own pre-declared threshold requires — so it does not in itself. The CENTCOM-confirmed 5-tanker strike is a larger single incident than the 3-tanker strike this pillar priced on Sept 6, but it is the same repeat pattern (Gulf of Oman, Kharg Island) responding to the same demand. A new category of event, so I am re-rating down modestly again (1/6/23/43/72, from 1/7/24/44/73) rather than sharply, consistent with the Sept 6 and Sept 8 cuts.

Prior cycle (Sept 8): the crowd is likely to either dismiss Rezaei's restricted-zone announcement as Iran "talking tough" without follow-through, or treat it as an imminent full closure of a new strike zone. **Me:** a real escalatory signal worth logging and worth a small cut, but it is not yet an executed act — no boundaries, no enforcement mechanism, and no confirmed incident tied to it as of this cycle's runbook. The flip-line clauses fire on it (no US casualty, no new state, Brent short of \$100) and it is consistent with — not a departure from — this pillar's past treatment of announced-but-unexecuted escalatory events. "Coming days" as bullish either — until it is actually signed, it's the same "very close" pattern this pillar has discounted for weeks.

Prior cycle (Sept 6): the crowd was likely to read CENTCOM's own confirmation of the Sept 5 tanker strike as a relief ("finally, official clarity") rather than what it actually was — a confirmation that a ballistic-missile attack on two US Navy warships that the US answered by destroying three tankers. Re-rated down modestly (1/8/25/45/73, from 1/9/27/47/74) rather than sharply, because none of it was more serious than previously known — was still a continuation of the same "resumption of direct US strikes" trajectory already priced in since Aug 30, not a new category of event. Sept 6's separate IRGC strike by the US, and the sufficiency rule is exactly what stops a claim like that from doing more work than it's earned.

The crowd: is likely to anchor on the wedding-strike casualty claim as the emotional center of today's news, and either (a) treat it as a confirmed atrocity driving the story, or (b) dismiss the whole thing. The US strike wave (nearly 100 targets, first-ever direct tanker strikes) is independently, multi-source confirmed regardless of how the casualty dispute resolves, and is the real story this cycle.

Me: cutting sharply to 1/9/27/47/74, versus the Sept 1 baseline (7/15/32/50/75, auto-stamped). This is the largest single-cycle P move this pillar has made since the Aug 30-31 flip-line-firing cut, and Alex's manual review. Three reasons, stated plainly: (1) the core wedding-casualty fact — the political and emotional driver of today's four-country Iranian retaliation — is single-narrative-sourced and well-reported; my confidence in today's sizing is lower than for a cleanly multi-sourced primary event, and I don't want to self-approve a cut this large resting partly on that; (2) the scale jump — ~50x — is sizing precedents (Jul 28 Jordan, Aug 30 Larak) don't cleanly cover, and sizing a cut for a genuinely new magnitude of event is exactly the kind of judgment call the runbook says shouldn't be quick. (3) the move is more costly than usual given what could follow. That said, the cut is still evidence-bounded, not panic-sized: kept under 8 points per window, and the four-country retaliation does NOT independently move anything.

My edge: the discipline here is refusing to let a single-source emotional fact do more work than it's earned, in either direction — not discarding it (it's genuinely the trigger for today's retaliation), but not letting it (and its count, tanker strikes, four-country retaliation, mutual escalation threats) support on their own. The crowd either over- or under-reacts to a claim like this; this pillar tries to size around it instead.

Honesty check against the tape: BTC fell from \$78,038.78 (Sept 1, Bitstamp) to \$76,581.44 (Sept 2) — a real, visible risk-off move that for once tracks the same direction as this pillar's own sharp risk-off evidence, not price action — but the comparison itself is logged here explicitly as an honesty check for the reader.

The Facts

As of September 16, 2026 — LIGHT DAILY touch (2026-09-16, draft). Hard numbers only, sources on the last page. New facts from this cycle appear first; earlier facts are carried forward unchanged (still load-bearing) below.

- ★ ★ **NEW — the IAEA Board of Governors voted Sept 9, 2026 to refer Iran's nuclear file to the UN Security Council.** A primary institutional action by the IAEA itself, escalating international pressure.
- ★ ★ **NEW — 130 Iranian lawmakers signed a statement Sept 12-13, 2026 calling on parliament to begin the legal process for Iran's withdrawal from the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty.** (globalsecurity.org mirror), Tehran Times, and Mehr News — 3 independent outlets, though two are Iranian state-affiliated, so treated as corroborated reporting of a documented parliamentary action.
- **Counterweight, same sourcing set:** President Pezeshkian publicly reiterated Iran is not seeking nuclear weapons, even as the parliamentary push proceeds. Foreign Ministry spokesman Esmail Qaumi said "Iran will not be involved in later stages" — a real escalatory step, not a completed NPT exit.
- **Nothing new found** on the Salalah Iran-GCC ministerial (still postponed, no new date), the Saudi East-West pipeline (still offline), or Hormuz shipping beyond what the Sept 15 baseline already covered.

Carried forward from the September 12 full weekly refresh and the daily touches since — still load-bearing, not contradicted:

- ★ ★ **NEW — Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline), the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route, was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory Sept 10 (Saudi Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request (AI Jazeera). Iraq's PM ordered a probe, dismissed the Maysan operations commander, and closed the Shalamchah border crossing as a precaution.**
- **Attribution caveat, stated carefully:** no group has claimed responsibility for the pipeline strike; the Saudi MFA statement attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state. Presumably established fact.
- **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire.
- **Counterweight, logged:** Trump's own account (same Dublin remarks) that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen — single-source as to substance, corroborated by the BRICS declaration (Sept 12, all members plus Saudi Arabia, Iran, and UAE) called for "exercising maximum restraint" and voiced concern over attacks on civilian/nuclear infrastructure — a mild, long-term

• **Re-verified independently:** the Mayyun (Perim) Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure (Sept 10-11) still holds, not disputed (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, Z

Carried forward from the Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft, auto-stamped — still load-bearing):

- ★ ★ **NEW — Houthis forces complete their sweep of Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline (capturing Dhubab and Murad by Sept 11, the last government-held coastal towns) and seize M** chokepoint moving from "closing in on" to actual island-level control (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald — 6+ independent). Yemen is existing theater, so the v
- **Counterweight, logged:** Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused — intelligence/targeting-data support of
- ★ ★ **NEW — UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 (issued 1910 UTC Sept 10) confirms four unidentified projectiles struck two vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire** (Gulf M
- **Logged, single-source, NOT used to move P:** IRGC's own claim to have separately struck a US Navy Saildrone Explorer-type unmanned vessel near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM c
- **Brent held near/above \$104 for a fifth consecutive session** (settled ~\$104.61 Sept 12, TradingEconomics/psuconnect.in) — confirming persistence of the already-fired "sustained >\$100" fl
- **BTC traded at \$76,916.53 on Sept 14** — up 1.4% from \$76,808.69 on Sept 13, which itself eased from \$77,269.22 on Sept 12 (local run.py quant refresh).
- ★ **CARRIED FORWARD — the "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause FIRES: Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107, after trading above \$108 intraday** Friday Sept 11, roughly 9% higher on the week despite a ~3% give-back (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics Sept 10-11, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent). Three morning Sept 10, logged ~\$101.25 as "Thursday Sept 10" — that was an intraday read, not the close.
- ★ ★ **NEW — fuller reporting of the Sept 9 shipping wave: Iran attacked 10 vessels near the Strait of Hormuz — 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers — the largest declared wave of shi** News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill — 4 independent). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does NOT fire.
- **Logged, single-source, NOT used to move P:** a compilation of Hormuz transit data puts throughput at 7 transits on Sept 9 against a Kpler 10-day moving average of 10-13 commodity vess
- **Counterweight, logged:** Friday Sept 11's ~3% Brent give-back is attributed to diplomatic efforts around the Strait of Hormuz and to the IEA's forecast of a 2.5 mb/d contraction in 2026 dem
- ★ **CARRIED FORWARD — CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base Sept 9, in retaliation for the Sept 8 five-tanker s** GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement) — clears the sufficiency bar. Jordan is a repeat target (struck Aug 30-31), so the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause does not
- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha on Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait**, a SECOND global shipping chokep Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail). Same actor/theater already priced; no strait closure or interdiction has actually been confirmed — outlets describe Houthis as "closing in on," not
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session**, more persistent than Sept 9's single-day intraday cross (CNBC: above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9 "sustained Brent > \$100" flip-line clause, but still short of a clean multi-session sustained call.
- **NEW — no widening to a further new state and no confirmed US casualty:** Jordan is a repeat target, and CENTCOM/Jordan both confirm no casualties from the Al Azraq strike; DCAS rem uncorroborated against CENTCOM's own statement).
- **BTC traded at \$77,063 on Sept 11** — down from \$77,993.99 on Sept 10 and \$79,052.40 on Sept 9 (local full quant refresh this cycle, run .py quant).

Carried forward from Sept 9 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ ★ **NEW — CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T D** days. Corroborated across 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24**, trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) on U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strike fears (CNBC "Brent crude tops \$100 as U independently fire this pillar's "sustained Brent > \$100" flip-line clause; the closest this cycle has come to it.
- **NEW — both Iranian missile attempts on the US Navy warship were evaded, no US personnel harmed** — the confirmed-US-casualty flip-line clause remains unfired.
- **NEW — no widening to a further new state:** Gulf of Oman and Kharg Island are both existing theater already struck in this war.
- **Iran's Sept 6-7 SNSC "restricted zone" announcement remains not-yet-executed** — no new dated development, not re-scored a second time.
- **BTC traded at \$79,052.40 on Sept 9** — up from \$78,435.62 on Sept 8 and \$79,090.41 on Sept 7 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 8 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced on-record, Sept 6-7, that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" beyond the Strait of Hormuz "in the coming days."** The zone would sanctions list. Corroborated across 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to Iranian state media (Press T
- **This is a threat of intent, not yet executed:** Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer states "further details, including the precise boundaries, have yet to be announced." Rezaei separately said an I
- **GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) tracker puts the blockade count at 92 vessels redirected, 3 disabled, 2 boarded** — up from Day 190's 87/3/2 (Sept 3), a continuation of the already-pr
- **BTC traded at \$78,435.62 on Sept 8** — down from \$79,090.41 on Sept 7 and \$80,338.98 on Sept 6 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 6 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil) confirms US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers Sept 5, resolving the tanker report this pillar had withheld p** M/T Kylo (completely destroyed in the Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (an aircraft carrier and a guided-missile destroyer), both of v 5+ other independent outlets, in addition to CENTCOM's own release.
- ★ **This revealed a materially more serious escalation than the Sept 5 baseline knew:** not a quiet single-tanker interdiction, but a direct, unprovoked IRGC missile attack on US Navy vessels a impose an even higher economic cost — taking out three of yours."
- **Sept 6's IRGC claims of further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels and a US naval drone** (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) remain US-unconfirmed as of this cyc
- **BTC traded at \$79,929.30 on Sept 6** — up from \$79,646.11 on Sept 5 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 2 (re-verified through the Sept 5 full weekly refresh and this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran, roughly 50x the scale of the Aug 30 Larak Island strike.** Targets included IRGC air-defense sites, radar insta corroborated: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI.
- ★ ★ **NEW — for the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms), under a newly reported Trump-approved "tanker for tanker" policy —** vessels.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent rose ~5% Tuesday Sept 1, its best session in 5 weeks, to ~\$95-96.6/bbl; WTI to ~\$91-92** — still short of the \$100/bbl flip line.
- ★ ★ **NEW, FLAGGED SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED — a US strike on Kuestak, Sirik County, Hormozgan (near the Strait) reportedly hit a wedding party.** The Hormozgan governor's c CENTCOM's Cmdr. Tim Hawkins told CBS News the US has neither confirmed nor denied it. The casualty claim itself originates with Iranian state/local authorities — wide Western-outlet picku alone does NOT move P; it is reported as context for the retaliation it triggered.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated ballistic-missile and drone strikes on US-linked bases in FOUR countries simultaneously: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, and Kuwait** REPEAT targets already struck earlier in this war (Jordan: Jul 28, Aug 30-31; Bahrain/Kuwait/Iraq: struck at various points Feb-Jul 2026), so the "widening to a FURTHER NEW state with confirm
- **NEW — most projectiles were intercepted:** Jordan (~10 of 25 intercepted, 3 landed, no reported casualties); Bahrain (most of roughly two dozen drones intercepted). No confirmed new US independently fires.

- ★ **NEW — both sides now on-record threatening larger future action:** President Trump threatened a "significantly larger response" if Iran retaliates further; an unnamed senior Iranian military official threatened escalation.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2** — down from \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 (Bitstamp), a real risk-off move.

Carried forward from the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week, Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting.** The Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity was struck by three unknown projectiles; the tanker was damaged but not sunk. No casualties, no environmental impact reported; UKMTO-logged. This follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25) incidents — the third such hit in the past week.
- ★ **Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; the UAE Ministry of Defense DENIES that base was targeted while CONFIRMING a separate cross-border drone incident.** The UAE Ministry of Defense denied Al Minhad was targeted, while separately confirming its air force intercepted an Iranian drone detected over UAE territorial waters, approaching from Iran. So: a disputed target claim, but a confirmed drone strike. Sources: Reuters, CNN, BBC, Al Jazeera, The New York Times, News, Seatrade Maritime, and Iran International.
- ★ **President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran,** calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo — on-record, multi-source) — explicitly stating he is still weighing further strikes.
- ★ **Brent crude continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday per multiple market-desk reports)** on fresh-clash fears — the session after the long Labor Day weekend, the second straight day of gains.
- ★ **Jordan was struck again Aug 30-31,** but remained a repeat, not a "further new," state per this pillar's own framing (already struck Jul 28 and again as part of the Aug 30 IRGC retaliation) — no new confirmed US combat death.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$78,038.78 on Sept 1** — down from \$78,447.16 on Aug 31 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Resumed direct US strike on Iranian territory, Aug 30, CONFIRMED via on-record CENTCOM spokesperson plus 20+ independent outlets.** US forces struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launcher sites in the Khuzestan province (CENTCOM) confirmed on the record; corroborated by Bloomberg, CNBC, NBC News, Reuters, Newsweek, ABC News, Al Jazeera, Fox News, RFE/RL, Epoch Times, Daily Caller, OANN, FXStreet, and others. This marks the first direct US strike on Iranian territory in consecutive-clean-night streak. **Directly fired this pillar's own pre-declared flip line** ("a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper... = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken").
- ★ **IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases, Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED via Jordan's own military statement plus multi-source reporting.** IRGC said it struck two US-linked Jordan airbases with ballistic missiles, causing "heavy damage" to base infrastructure, unconfirmed by the US or Jordan beyond the interception — logged as Iran-sourced, not scored as fact. IRGC separately confirmed Iranian soldiers/civilians killed in the strikes.
- ★ **Press (Reuters/CNBC) framed the renewed exchange as weighing on Asian equities and US futures,** reversing the prior two-week Brent decline.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$78,447.16 on Aug 31** — up from \$77,666.16 on Aug 29 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-29_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov.** Press releases sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Financial System") — corroborated by state.gov and 3+ independent trade-compliance/crypto-intelligence outlets (TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes) plus law-firm client alerts. ~60 entities/individuals/vessels named. **For the first time, digital assets was explicitly named as a sanctionable sector** — 30 crypto addresses across Bitcoin, Ethereum, and TRON were listed. Unlike prior cycles' "promised but not delivered" Melli-Dubai designation.
- ★ **★ NEW — Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor, Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of fm.gov.om/en/53722.** A genuine upgrade: in every prior cycle, the US and Oman have agreed to a temporary corridor. Statement terms: a temporary 7-mile-wide joint navigational corridor (entry/exit through Iranian waters), a joint mine-clearing project, and continuing technical talks toward a permanent corridor. The corridor is "closed" pending US compliance with the lapsed June MoU. No public fee/revenue terms were disclosed; a separate IRGC spokesman claim (Aug 26) of an Iran-Oman revenue-sharing deal is still unconfirmed.
- ★ **NEW — two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents.** Aug 24, off Oman's coast (engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties, UKMTO); Aug 27 (fire onboard, extinguished, vessel damaged, no casualties, UKMTO).
- ★ **NEW — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing, Aug 28** (corroborated by UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire): US forces cleared Iranian vessels from the Strait of Hormuz since blockade enforcement began; ~75 vessels turned back and 3 disabled for evading the blockade; no oil has been exported from Iran since the blockade resumed. Read as continuing the trend of no new confirmed US combat death.
- ★ **NEW — IMO's six-month casualty count (Aug 28, quasi-primary IMO briefing, corroborated by 4 outlets) settles at 19-20 dead** (seafarers + port workers) across 68-70 incidents — the highest since the start of the crisis.
- ★ **NEW — Trump declared the Strait "demined" Aug 25** with a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 tanker attack.
- ★ **NEW — the first quantified Hormuz transit-volume increase of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week for the week of Aug 17-23** (USNI News, citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — quasi-primary source). A small fraction (~10-15%) of the ~110-130/day (~770-910/week) pre-war baseline, but a genuine first uptick.
- ★ **NEW — Brent eased for a SECOND straight week:** ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27, weekly loss >5%) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving further from the peak.
- ★ **NEW — no new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29** (checked directly — one initial-looking hit, Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the statistics).
- ★ **NEW — no new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran found** — GlobalSecurity's Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) confirms a 28th consecutive night with no confirmed strike.
- ★ **BTC closed at \$77,666.16 on Aug 29** — up modestly from \$77,266.84 on Aug 22 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the abandoned Aug 28 draft (2026-08-28_draft — never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed; re-confirmed independently this cycle, not taken on faith): the two Aug 24/Aug 27 tanker incidents and the Aug 28 briefing. All re-verified fresh this cycle.

Carried forward from the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23 — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Casualty toll (as of Aug 22): real, but a range, not a point figure.** That cycle cross-checked the cumulative Hormuz-campaign death toll directly: Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" page (highlighted "Incidents" page (fetched directly) shows 19 seafarer fatalities across 68 incidents as of Aug 21, but appears to aggregate the broader Middle East (possibly including a separate Aug 22 briefing). **cumulative deaths, 17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers** — now settled higher by this cycle's IMO six-month count above (19-20).
- ★ **No new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22.** Independent re-checking for vessel strikes, seizures, or Iran-related military incidents in that window found nothing beyond the Aug 22 draft baseline.
- ★ **The UAE missile-attack claim reconciles to the same known Aug 18 episode, not a new one.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) described a missile attack on the UAE. Reconciliation it is the same episode already in the draft baseline (CBS/CNN/Al Jazeera, Aug 18 strike / Aug 19 embargo response) — a one-day cross-outlet dating variance describing one event from two different perspectives on their own claims.
- ★ **CENTCOM's blockade/interdiction tally was climbing incrementally as of Aug 22** (68 vessels redirected vs. ~67 shortly before) — now superseded by this cycle's Aug 28 briefing above.
- ★ **The Iran-Oman single-corridor deal remained unsigned as of Aug 22;** the underlying 60-day US-Iran negotiation window (from the June 17 Versailles MOU) expired Aug 17 without a confirmed deal (no accepted deal).
- ★ **Brent was ~\$93-95/bbl as of Aug 20-21,** a second straight weekly gain (~6%), the highest since late July — now reversed by this cycle's two-week Brent decline above.
- ★ **Strait of Hormuz traffic: trackers disagreed on the exact daily transit count as of Aug 22** (estimates ranged ~1% to ~20% of the pre-war ~130-170/day baseline) — now superseded by this cycle's Aug 28 briefing above.

From the Aug 22 morning draft (score set 2026-08-22_draft) — carried forward, casualty framing softened above:

- ★ **★ NEW — a fatal strike on the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign's latest victim (CORRECTED: not the first fatality, contrary to this draft's earlier framing).** The Liberia-flagged bulk carrier M/V *Al-Salam* was struck by a missile in the southern corridor, Aug 17-18; the chief engineer was killed. UKMTO's report is corroborated by 7+ independent outlets (Maritime Executive, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News, Riviera, Safety of Sea, etc.). **clean figure** — see the NEW (draft2) item above. This report's own prior cycles never surfaced or scored on that toll — flagged honestly as a research gap, not new information, and a reason to carry forward.
- ★ **★ NEW — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22.** The Liberia-flagged tanker Amara was boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17; Iran's Fars News says it's held for non-payment under Iranian law, not only to active enforcement and detention.
- ★ **Correction to the record:** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only; Iran denies, calls it a possible "false flag") and is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE since the start of the crisis, predating this incident. That "novel escalation vector" framing is not carried forward.
- ★ **No new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran since the Aug 1 stand-down** (GlobalSecurity Day-175 tracker) — the pause holds, a modest stabilizing factor.

- **Sanctions remain mostly rhetoric.** Treasury Secretary Bessent has repeatedly promised the "toughest sanctions in history" / to "collapse Iran's economy," with the actual package pushed to Hezbollah-linked individuals/networks — real, but narrower than the promised Iran-economy package, which has not yet been unveiled.
- **Brent ~\$93-95/bbl (Aug 21)** (TradingEconomics, Vantage, Fortune) — up modestly on sanctions anticipation, still well under the \$100 flip line.
- **Iran said Aug 22 it will allow Iraqi oil tankers through the Strait** (state media) — a mild, narrow normalizing signal amid otherwise hardening posture.
- **Mediation continues without a breakthrough;** Qatar/Oman still pushing diplomacy. Tehran "dismissed" Trump's sanctions threats Aug 21 and called the new sanctions a "declaration of war."
- **No new confirmed US combat death found in this window.**
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 on Aug 22** — up +7.4% from Aug 20's close of \$71,882.92 (Bitstamp). See The Claim for the honesty check on this divergence from the pillar's own evidence.

Carried forward from Aug 18-20 (still load-bearing — the UAE "novel escalation" framing is corrected above, not repeated here):

- **The UAE reported Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory Aug 18; Iran denies it, calling it a possible "false flag."** Bloomberg, CNN, and CP24 (Aug 18) report the UAE says one missile attributed dispute, reported as such, not used alone to move P.
- **The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran, announced Aug 19** (CNN, Washington Post, Fortune) — a dated, corroborated, structural response, independent of *News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday*) describing this same missile attack and embargo was initially flagged as a possible second incident by this cycle's adversarial pass — confirmed on reconciliation.
- **A commercial vessel was struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait, Aug 18,** causing engine damage and one crew injury (UK Maritime Trade Operations).
- **The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned as of Aug 20-22.** Iran claims route coordinates were agreed Aug 18; Oman has not confirmed.

Carried forward from Aug 16-18 (independently re-verified against fresh primary sources this cycle — all confirmed accurate, still load-bearing):

- ★ **The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed Monday, Aug 18, without a signed deal.** CBS News's live desk (direct-fetched) reports the deadline expired that day; Iran's foreign ministry downplayed the first time either side has publicly framed the other as already in breach, rather than "very close." Trump told reporters he has "no time schedule" to resolve the conflict (a framing he softened, not repeated).
- ★ **Trump threatened Oman.** In a Fox News interview (Aug 17, per CBS's live desk), Trump said the US would take action if Oman "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait, and that "we'd handle it" if followed Iran announcing its own agreement with Oman on shipping routes through the Strait.
- ★ **Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed further.** CBS News's live desk, citing maritime monitors, reports only 3-5 vessel transits over the Aug 15-16 weekend, versus 31 the prior weekend; CENTCOM's baseline cited in the Aug 18 draft (~130/day) was independently re-checked this cycle; the more defensible figure is closer to ~110/day. The discrepancy is flagged here for transparency; it does not reflect a change in the underlying data.
- **Brent rose to ~\$90.9-91.0/bbl (Aug 17-18)** — up 2.7% on Aug 17 per Yahoo Finance/Fortune/TradingEconomics, from the \$87-90 range priced in Aug 13-16 — still well under the \$100 flip line.
- **BTC closed at \$64,285.10 on Aug 18** — +2.1% vs. Aug 16's close of \$62,937.03 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from Aug 14-16 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Three ADNOC tanker incidents in 48 hours (Aug 14-15), comparable in kind to the established pattern.** The UAE accused Iran/IRGC of striking two ADNOC vessels Aug 14 (Al Jazeera, not CNN; no projectile"). Iran did not claim direct responsibility either time; UAE's Foreign Ministry called it "piracy." No new state targeted, no casualties at the time — now compounding into the Aug 18 strike.

Carried forward from Aug 11-14 (still load-bearing):

- **Aug 13 — Hormuz deal remains unsigned, stuck on hardened compensation demands from both sides.** Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, and The Hill (six independent sources) reported the deal was "very close" but stalled on asset unfreezing, and sanctions relief; Trump separately amended his own compensation demand to include damages "to the people of Lebanon, Syria, Yemen, and Gaza" — a hardening of the demand.
- **Brent eased to ~\$87-90/bbl** (from the \$98-100+ spikes logged in late July) as Hormuz traffic stayed low as of Aug 13-14; a live tracker (straits.live) showed the Strait at "day 166" of closure - still well under the \$100 flip line.
- **Aug 13 — Araghchi again called the Hormuz deal "very close" while conditioning full reopening on the US "making amends" over the June MoU** (CNN, NPR, Al Jazeera, France 24, Bloomberg).
- ★ **Aug 11 — a Houthi "double-tap" missile strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah in the Bab al-Mandeb Strait (Red Sea, not Hormuz) killed 6 (4 crew, 2 rescue workers)** per Yemeni government. The same Houthi-proxy Red Sea theater and comparable in kind to the Aug 8 ADNOC tanker hit and Aug 9 Jazan refinery strike already logged without moving P.
- **Iran's Supreme Leader reshuffled top military leadership (new armed-forces chief of staff, new IRGC commander)** — a structural development with an ambiguous, not-yet-legible direct impact.
- ★ **Houthi forces drone-struck Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery on Aug 9,** a 400,000 bpd facility on Saudi Arabia's Red Sea coast. NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba (six independent sources) reported the strike, resulting fire the same day, with no announced extended production impact.

Carried forward from Aug 8-10 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Iranian FM Araqchi says the Oman shipping-route deal is "very close" but conditions full reopening on new demands, including US compensation to Iran.** Reuters (via Investing.com) reported the deal was "very close" but stalled on a new shipping route through the strait, but that reopening it would depend on further conditions, and that the previous shipping traffic separation scheme is "no longer acceptable to Tehran."
- ★ **The UAE says Iran struck another ship in the strait; Oman condemns "repeated attacks."** The same Reuters report: the UAE separately reported a fresh Iranian strike on a vessel transiting the Strait, described negotiations with Iran as "positive and constructive."

Carried forward from Aug 1-8 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents, Jul 31 - Aug 5, that daily two-day checks missed or undercounted.** The LNG carrier Gaslog Shanghai was struck and disabled carrying 160,000 cu m of gas, the engine room, suffering a blackout with one crew member missing (Aug 3); two more explosions were reported near Kumzar (Aug 5). The IMO's cumulative incident tally now stands at 65.
- ★ **★ NEW — a new front: Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia on Aug 7,** wounding 11 civilians (7 Saudi, 1 Yemeni, 2 Egyptian, 1 Pakistani, including a 4-year-old with burns). The Times, OIC statement corroborate).
- ★ **★ NEW — Saudi Arabia, Turkey, and Pakistan signed a mutual-defense "Mecca" pact on Aug 7** (an attack on one is an attack on all) — a structural, deterrence-oriented development that may impact the Strait.
- **Aug 7-8 — Iran announced what it calls a finalized agreement with Oman on Hormuz shipping,** banning American and Israeli vessels and fining violators up to 20% of cargo value (IRNA, Al Jazeera), insisting on zero tolls, permits, or approvals. The fundamental fee/sovereignty dispute is unresolved, not narrowed. This claim's specific draft terms trace to Fars News (Iranian state media).
- **Correction: Trump's Aug 2 "perimeters of a deal" framing was contested by his own later remarks.** Two days after claiming "the perimeters of a deal has been agreed to," Trump called it "a very preliminary" outpacing substance, a pattern that recurred all week (positive announcements paired with continuing attacks or contradictions within 1-2 days each time).
- **Brent held a \$82-86/bbl range through the week** — up modestly, not pricing a resolved crisis.
- **BTC closed at \$65,006.64 on Aug 8** — essentially flat vs. Aug 7's close of \$65,000.00.

Carried forward from Aug 1-7 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 7 — the Iran-Oman joint statement remained unsigned as of that check, still in final drafting.** Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei described the statement outlining agreed terms.

Carried forward from Aug 1-6 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 6 — Iran and Oman reached an "understanding in principle" on the Hormuz route map.** Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi told IRNA: "an understanding in principle" (Bloomberg (two articles), CBS, Al Jazeera (two articles), Euronews, and Military.com).
- ★ **Aug 6 — the fee dispute first surfaced as the remaining obstacle.** Iran is seeking fees of 5-7% of cargo value from transiting ships; Oman is discussing fees around 3%; Washington wants a proposed passage deal is "not feasible for shipping industry."

Carried forward from Aug 1-5 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 1 — the first quiet night in days.** [globalsecurity.org](#)'s day-by-day war tracker reported no new US strikes on Iran overnight Jul 31 following the heavy Jul 29-30 wave; Brent fell ~2% on drawing backing from 14 countries.
- ★ **Aug 1-2 — fresh, multi-source-corroborated attacks on Hormuz shipping.** Bloomberg: a Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) was struck while transiting the Strait. UKMTO/globalsecurity vessel disabled. These directly contradicted the Aug 1 "quiet night" framing — the pause was not durable.
- **Aug 2 — the Saudi-led naval coalition kept solidifying.** Al Jazeera, The National, DefenseMirror, and Tribune reported 14 confirmed member countries and 43 nations represented at a first attack-or-lull headline.
- ★ **Aug 4 — Trump canceled a planned joint US-Israeli strike on Iranian energy infrastructure.** Multiple outlets (NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CNN) reported a full Strait of Hormuz reopening. No US strikes on Iran proper have been reported since the cancellation.
- **Aug 4 — Iran continues to deny any direct US talks.** Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei: "we currently have no negotiations with the United States; the negotiations are with Oman." Trump: "I don't know."
- ★ **Aug 4 — a bulker was struck by a projectile and suffered a full blackout in the Strait** ([globalsecurity.org](#), [iransitrep.com](#)) — active attacks continued even as the diplomatic framework was being discussed.
- ★ **Aug 5 — the first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal.** Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, and Al-Quds report the US, Iran, and Oman nearing an agreement on transit fees during the interim period, and a plan to clear naval mines from the median lane within 30 days. The US aimed to announce the deal Aug 6.
- **Aug 5 — still unsigned.** CNN quotes a Gulf official putting the odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday at only 50-50. The Strait remains formally impassable to normal traffic pending finalization of the deal.
- **BTC closed at \$64,661.55 on Aug 5** — up ~1.7% from the \$63,579.68 close on Jul 31, continuing its resilience through a week where the war's own risk signal moved both up and down.

Carried forward from the July 30 full refresh (still load-bearing):

- ★ **The lull was real, then it broke: Iran's IRGC struck a US/CENTCOM base at Muwaffaq Salti, Jordan (Jul 28).** Confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNN, Axios, RT, JPost) — broke after a genuine 2-3 day pause in CENTCOM strikes (Jul 25-27) and on the same day Trump was publicly touting "very friendly" talks with Netanyahu at the White House — both things happened.
- ★ **The US retaliated with a "heavy wave of strikes" (Jul 29)** — explosions reported at Bandar Abbas, Kish Island, Qeshm Island, and Khuzestan Province (CNN). Trump: "it's our turn to hit them."
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Iraq: US and Saudi Arabia conducted joint strikes on Iran-backed Popular Mobilisation Forces across Iraq (Jul 29),** CENTCOM-confirmed, hitting sites in Baghdad, Wasit, and Basra. The Iraqi government called it a "flagrant violation of sovereignty." This is Saudi Arabia's first turn as a direct co-belligerent in this war. A claim that "six Iranian IRGC advisors" were also killed is single-sourced.
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Egypt: a drone hit a US-owned FSRU vessel and a tanker at Egypt's Damietta port (Jul 29)** — the first strike on Egyptian soil in this war (Al Jazeera, CNBC, Times of Israel) — remains unresolved.
- **Brent rebounded from the lull-low.** Brent fell to ~\$90/bbl (-6.7%) during the Jul 25-27 lull, then rose back to ~\$92-93/bbl by Jul 30 (+~3.5% day-over-day, +24.6% month-over-month) on the lull. It then dropped from this report.
- **Iran continues rejecting a direct-talks framing even as Trump claims progress.** Iran FM spokesman Baghaei, Jul 27: "We have no negotiations with the United States at present" — directly contradicted the "quiet night" framing. Iran separately rejected an Oman joint-Hormuz-management proposal on Jul 28, insisting on controlling its own lane.
- **Congress split on competing War Powers resolutions (Jul 23, carried forward, no new action since):** House passed a nonbinding one 214-208 (4 GOP defectors); the Senate's binding one 60-40 remains on the table, unaccepted; Iran separately rejected an Oman joint-Hormuz-management proposal on Jul 28, insisting on controlling its own lane.
- ★ **The Pentagon casualty-count dispute (18 vs. 14) is confirmed stale, not a fresh Jul 30 event.** The DCAS toll briefly rose to 18 (Jul 23) then reverted to 14 (Jul 24) amid a credibly-sourced dispute already logged last cycle — one daily touch this week re-cited the Jul 24 CNBC article as if it were new; it is not.
- **Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed to normal commercial traffic** — ~10 transits/day versus a normal baseline near 88/day (IMF PortWatch), unchanged from prior cycles. IRGC, JPost, and others report.
- **No formal MoU withdrawal by either side.** The 60-day window to ~Aug 16 remains intact and un-triggered.
- **Israel remains out of direct engagement** — no confirmed direct Israel-Iran exchange since June 7-8; the widened fronts (Iraq, Egypt) involve the US, Saudi Arabia, and unclaimed actors, not Israel.
- **The "Layla" tanker claim (Jul 23) remains unconfirmed** after a full week — AIS data dark, no primary confirmation found. Downgraded from "watch" to "discard pending new evidence."
- **The baseline (still true, still load-bearing):** June 2025 "12-Day War" — BTC dipped to a ~\$98,225 intraday low, reclaimed \$107k+ within days, a fast V. The far larger 2026 war still hasn't crossed the baseline yet.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The upside is still the **"buy-the-invasion" rebound**. Anchors: Russia-Ukraine (Feb 24, 2022) — BTC fell ~8% to a ~\$34,300 intraday low, posted a +14.5% up-day on Feb 28, ended ~+25-28% by Mar 10. The Aug 30-31 direct US-Iran exchange has now escalated sharply further: a ~50x-larger US strike wave, the war's first direct strikes on Iranian government tankers, and a four-country Iranian strike on a US ship (Oman's own government confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor). That corridor claim is still technically on the table, unretracted, but a fresh, much-larger strike-and-retaliation cycle may be in the works. Sept 1's \$78,038.78 — a real, visible risk-off move that for once tracks the same direction as this pillar's own evidence. That's logged as an honesty check for the reader (see The Claim), not treacherous. The prize remains unchanged in shape: a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both sides actually accept, signed and holding a full clean week without a new attack, fatality, or seizure, would shift the prize further away than it was even yesterday, not closer — the Prize doesn't feed the math, it tells you what the lean is worth acting on.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- **The cut may still be too small, even at 1/9/27/47/74.** Nearly 100 targets, the war's first direct tanker strikes, and a four-country simultaneous retaliation is a genuinely different order of magnitude (P=1, barely above the floor) understate just how close this now sits to the worst-case scenario this pillar has always flagged as the real tail risk, and that keeping the cut "under 8 points per week" is a disservice.
- **Leaving it as a draft may itself be too cautious.** The independently-confirmed facts alone — CENTCOM's own ~100-target count, the first-ever tanker strikes, the four-country retaliation, broken by the wedding-strike claim at all; a reader could argue this pillar is using the single-source caveat as an excuse to soften a call the non-disputed facts already support, rather than a genuine evidence-based caution.
- **The cut may be too small.** This report explicitly pre-declared "a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" as the line that breaks the dip-buy thesis — and calibrated the actual cut to a 1/9/27/47/74 line. A stricter reader could argue firing your own flip line warrants a materially larger cut than a routine tanker incident, precisely because the report itself said in advance this class of event warranted a larger cut.
- **The cut may be too large.** One resumed-strike night after ~28-30 clean nights is, so far, a single interdiction event (stopping a mine-laying attempt) rather than evidence of a full campaign. A single event is a contained, one-off enforcement action that doesn't repeat. If no further strikes follow in the next few days, this cut may prove to have moved faster than the evidence ultimately warranted.
- **The Oman corridor confirmation (Aug 25) is not retracted.** Oman's own Foreign Ministry still has not walked back its Aug 25 joint statement — the first time both parties on the "deal" sided with the US. The 1yr/3yr windows are being cut too by association with a fundamentally 1mo/3mo-scoped shock.
- **The Aug 24 sanctions package is arguably a bigger structural story than this week's kinetic exchange.** It was the first Iran sanctions action in this war to explicitly name digital assets as a target, before, and one that doesn't fade if the current strike cycle cools.
- **No confirmed US casualty, still.** The single hardest-edged clause of this pillar's own flip line — a confirmed new US combat death — remains unfired even after this week's exchange; a reader could argue that.
- **Thin sample, still.** The bullish long-term read rests on a handful of dip-and-recover events, all in a bull regime — geopolitical shocks don't always V-recover, and a fresh direct strike exchange warrants a larger sample.

- **Two more restraint signals landed this cycle, logged honestly — a reader could argue they're under-weighted.** The BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12) — signed by S over attacks on civilian and nuclear infrastructure, and Trump's own account describes the Houthis privately signaling they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen. Neither moves P (one is restraint signals like these get folded in as a line, not a re-rate — a stricter reader could argue that asymmetry itself biases the cut direction over time even when each individual scoring decision

The Triggers

*Dated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. As of Sept 16, 2026: the IAEA's UNSC referral (Sept 9) and the 130-lawmaker NPT-withdrawal push (Sept 12-13) are the newest entries, driving this cycle's 6/12 below) — a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper, confirmed via on-record CENTCOM statements and 20+ independent outlets; escalation continued sharply Sept 1-2 — a materially larger strike wave and a four-country retaliation; CENTCOM's secretary announces intent to declare a restricted zone beyond Hormuz into the Persian Gulf, not yet executed; CENTCOM confirms a FIVE-tanker strike Sept 8, and Brent crosses \$100 intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24; the US Navy's M/T Stark (DDG 1000) is moving from "closing in on" to actual island-level control, though it does not independently fire a fresh flip-line clause (top row). **As of the Sept 13 light daily touch, the first de-escalation datapoint in six weeks landed: Iran's Monday Sept 14 on Strait of Hormuz navigation, safe shipping routes and mine clearance — the first such gathering since the war began in February (Iranian MFA statement, primary, plus 6+ independent outlets). statement that no deal is expected, the fact that the agenda concerns managing a strait Iran still controls, and continued fighting on Sept 13 (a fatal vessel attack near Qeshm Island, a Houthi projectile on Jazan, a clean week. In the prior Sept 12 full weekly refresh, a third distinct Saudi oil-infrastructure strike landed — drones launched from Iraqi territory hit Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement) and US-casualty clause fires.***

DATE	EVENT
FIRE Sept 9, reported Sept 12-16 — PRIMARY (IAEA Board of Governors institutional action)	The IAEA Board of Governors voted to refer Iran's nuclear file to the UN Security Council , escalating international pressure over Iran's nuclear activities. Separately, 130 Iranian lawmakers signed a statement Sept 12-13 calling on parliament to begin the legal process for NPT withdrawal, with a bill is being drafted (RFE/RL, Tehran Times, Mehr News — 3 independent outlets). Counterweight: President Pezeshkian publicly reiterated Iran is not seeking a deal. Ministry says the withdrawal bill "is still being prepared."
FIRE Sept 13 — PRIMARY (Oman News Agency statement) plus 5+ independent outlets (Arab News, Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News, Malay Mail)	The Salalah ministerial was POSTPONED, one day before it was to convene, with NO new date. ONA: the meeting is "postponed to a later date ... in conducive to a constructive dialogue." Bahrain had explicitly ruled out attending; no GCC state had confirmed; the UAE had downgraded to a minister of requested the delay citing Yemen and calls that a pretext — <i>single-party-sourced to Iranian officials, reported not scored</i> . Separately, FM Araqchi said the I not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz" (Tehran Times/Mehr). Brent +2.8% past \$107, WTI \$102.34 — <i>market prices, reported not scored</i> .
Announced Fri Sept 11, reported Sept 11-12 — PRIMARY (Iranian MFA statement) plus 6+ independent outlets; SUPERSEDED — the meeting was postponed Sept 13, see the row above	First Iran-GCC ministerial meeting since the war began in February. The foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and Iraq convene in Salalah, Oman navigation — safe/temporary commercial shipping routes, mine clearance and short-term management of the waterway, built on weeks of Oman-mediated the gathering aims "to promote better understanding among the countries of the region and help strengthen shared regional security" (Al Jazeera Sept 1 Oman Observer, The Business Standard, Business Recorder, ARMENPRESS, SBS). Logged counterweights: Bahrain announced Sept 12 it will not attend; an signed deal is expected; Tehran is weighing a transit service-fee regime, i.e. the agenda is about managing a strait Iran still controls
Sept 13, reported same day (Al Jazeera live blog) — Iran's attribution is Iran's own and is NOT treated as established	A commercial vessel was attacked near Qeshm Island inside the Strait of Hormuz, killing one and wounding four; an Iranian official blamed the "US terror struck Jazan, Saudi Arabia, causing injuries and damaging a mosque. Houthi forces and Yemen's internationally recognised government continued trading
Friday Sept 11 — a market price, reported NOT used to move P	Brent gave back 4.24% to ~\$104.26, the first meaningful downside session since the sustained->\$100 flip-line clause fired; wire coverage attributes it to t IEA's demand-contraction forecast (TradingEconomics, Forbes)
Attack Sept 10, Saudi MFA statement/confirmation Sept 11 (primary) plus 6+ independent outlets — sponsorship UNDETERMINED (Iraqi-origin, no group claim)	Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — its primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route — hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory; Saudi stations near Riyadh/Medina struck, injuries and material damage, will not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times OilPrice.com). Iraq's PM ordered a probe, dismissed the Maysan operations commander, closed the Shalamchah border crossing. Trump (Dublin): Iran "pr hedged, unconfirmed, NOT treated as fact
Fired Sept 10-11, escalated to island seizure Sept 11, CONFIRMED via 6+ independent outlets — no strait closure yet	Houthi forces complete their sweep of Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline (capturing Dhubab, Murad) and seize Mayyun (Perim) Island in the Bab continues for Zuqar Island (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Saudi Crown Prince MBS's request for direct US strikes on (intel/targeting support offered instead)
Sept 10 (UKMTO Warning 133-26, issued 1910 UTC), reported Sept 11 — CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus 3+ independent outlets	Four unidentified projectiles struck two vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire (UKMTO; Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill con move P (single-source, IRGC claim only): a separate IRGC claim of a strike on a US Navy Saildrone near the Strait entrance, no US/CENTCOM confirmation
FIRE Sept 10-11 — a flip-line clause, CONFIRMED via 4+ independent market sources	"Sustained Brent close above \$100" — Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 (above \$108 intraday), its highest since May the first time since May; Brent still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, ~9% higher on the week (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire, TradingEconomics, Vantage consecutive sessions above \$100. <i>Correction:</i> the Sept 10 cycle logged ~\$101.25 as that Thursday's level — an intraday read, not the close
Fired Sept 9, fuller reporting landed Sept 10-11, CONFIRMED via 4 independent outlets (Reuters wire)	Iran attacked 10 vessels near the Strait of Hormuz — 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers — the largest declared wave of shipping attacks by either least one seafarer killed, one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill)
Fired Sept 9, CONFIRMED via CENTCOM/Jordan's own military statement plus multi-outlet reporting	IRGC retaliates for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base — Jordan's armed forces in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement)
Fired Sept 10, CONFIRMED via 5+ independent outlets — chokepoint NOT yet closed	Iran-aligned Houthi forces seize the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a SECOND global sh Hormuz (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail)
Second straight session, logged Sept 10 — SUPERSEDED by the Sept 10-11 firing above	Brent crude trades near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session — above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9 for the first time since May; the Sept 10 cycle level, which proved to be an intraday read (Thursday closed above \$107)
Crossed intraday Sept 9, CONFIRMED via CNBC and ABC News — NOT a sustained close	Brent crude tops \$100/bbl intraday for the first time since July 24 , trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil-supply worries (U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries," ABC News)
Fired Sept 8, CONFIRMED via CENTCOM's own press release plus 5+ independent outlets	CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (G (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tanker American Warship," centcom.mil; NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org corroborating)
Announced Sept 6-7, on-record, corroborated by 8+ independent outlets — NOT yet executed	Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" beginning at the US Navy's blockade line and extending coming days," with any vessel entering it placed on Iran's sanctions list; he separately says an Iran-Oman corridor agreement will be signed "in the comin Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu, Newsbytes, WFLA, GlobalSecurity.org)
Fired Sept 5, CONFIRMED Sept 6 via CENTCOM's own press release plus 5+ independent outlets	CENTCOM confirms US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers Sept 5 — M/T Downy (disabled, Kharg Island), M/T Stark 1 (disabled, Jask) Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (a carrier and a guided-missile destroyer), both of which evaded

	(centcom.mil; Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC corroborating)
Claimed Sept 6, single-source (IRGC) — NOT independently used to move P	Iran's IRGC claims further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels, and a strike on a US naval drone entering the Strait of Hormuz (Euronews)
Fired Sept 3, CONFIRMED — repeat targets, widening clause did NOT fire	Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE) — a US official confirmed no US-manned facility was followed
Fired Sept 1-2, CONFIRMED via 9 independent outlets	CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, comms sites, anti-ship cruise missiles, roughly 50x the scale of the Aug 30 Larak strike (Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI)
Fired Sept 1-2, CONFIRMED, novel	For the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms) under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy
Reported Sept 1-2, SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact — NOT independently used to move P	A US strike on Kuestak, Hormozgan reportedly hit a wedding party — Hormozgan governor's office: 4 of at least 5 dead (incl. a 4-year-old), 60+ injured; US confirmed nor denied it
Fired Sept 2, CONFIRMED via multi-source reporting — widening clause did NOT fire	IRGC coordinated ballistic-missile/drone strikes on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait — most projectiles intercepted; 1 confirmed combat death
Fired Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting	A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week: the Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity struck by three unknown projectiles ~17nm northeast of Khasab, Oman (ballast tank), no casualties — follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25)
Claimed Aug 31, DISPUTED target / CONFIRMED incursion	Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; UAE MoD DENIES the base was targeted while CONFIRMING it intercepted an Iranian drone in territorial waters
Fired Aug 31, on-record — not a de-escalation signal	President Trump said on-record he is still weighing further strikes on Iran , calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo)
Fired Aug 30, CONFIRMED — FLIP LINE TRIGGERED	Resumption of direct US strikes on Iranian territory: CENTCOM struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Larak Island after observing prep to fire sea mines; first strike on Iran since Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-night clean streak; corroborated by 20+ outlets plus on-record CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Tim Hawkins
Fired Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED (Iran-claimed damage NOT independently confirmed)	IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases (King Hussein, Al-Azraq) — Jordan's military intercepted 8 missiles; Iran claimed damage by US/Jordan beyond interception; no confirmed US casualty
Fired Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package — home.treasury.gov sb0613/sb0614, OFAC recent-actions entry 20260824; ~60 entities/individuals sanctioned; 13902 sectoral determinations; FIRST TIME digital assets named a sanctionable sector, 30 crypto addresses (BTC/ETH/TRON) listed; corroborated by state. CryptoTimes, law-firm alerts; continued Aug 28 with a Bank Melli-Dubai designation
Fired Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor — fm.gov.om/en/53722; 7-mile joint navigational corridor (entry/exit through the Strait of Hormuz) cleared; clearing project, continuing talks toward a permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum"; still explicitly "temporary," no fee terms disclosed; Iran said "remains closed" pending US compliance
Fired Aug 24 & Aug 27, re-verified Aug 29	Two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents: Aug 24, off Oman's coast, engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties (UKMTO); Aug 27, same-day, crew safe (UKMTO). Neither incident's attribution confirmed by any party.
Fired Aug 25, re-verified Aug 29 — real but NOT durable	Trump announced the Strait of Hormuz "has been demined" and declared a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines, backed by Space Force surveillance (Axios, CNN, News, multiple corroborating) — the Aug 27 tanker incident above landed two days later, undercutting durability
Aug 28, CONFIRMED — re-verified Aug 29	CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing: Iranian sea mines cleared from the internationally-recognized shipping lanes; ~1,500 mines destroyed; enforcement began; ~75 turned back, 3 disabled for evasion; no Iranian oil exports since blockade resumed (UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Heral
Aug 28 IMO briefing, quasi-primary, corroborated by 4 outlets	Six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the previously-reported 15-19 range
Week of Aug 17-23, reported Aug 21 & Aug 28 (USNI News/Lloyd's List)	First confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week, 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29→42) — a new baseline
Claimed Aug 26, single-source, NOT USED — re-checked Aug 29	IRGC spokesman claims Iran and Oman agreed to share Hormuz revenue and delineate waters (Sepah News, Iranian state military source; via Bloomberg, Reuters, The Wall Street Journal) — but Oman's own Foreign Ministry did NOT confirm it, the two countries' own joint statement described only an "interim framework" with no mention of revenue sharing; Iran's own spokesman said the US is "obstructing this process"
Checked Aug 27 — GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker	28th consecutive night with no confirmed US/CENTCOM strike on Iran
Checked directly Aug 22-29 — no new event	No new confirmed US combat death. One initial-looking hit (Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton) was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the standard
Fired Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative, but CORRECTED framing, toll RE-VERIFIED as a range	Fatal strike in the tanker-attack campaign: bulker Minoan Dignity struck, chief engineer killed
Fired Aug 17, held to Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	First Iranian vessel seizure since June 22: tanker Amara boarded near Qeshm Island, held under Iran's post-MoU toll regime
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED reported, DISPUTED attribution, single-source; RECONCILED this cycle	The UAE reports Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory , one landing in territorial waters; Iran denies involvement, calls it a possible "false flag" attack
Announced Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, structural	The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran

Reported Aug 20, still unsigned as of Aug 22 draft2 — continuation, not yet resolved	The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned; Iran claims coordinates agreed Aug 18, Oman has not confirmed
No new incident, checked Aug 19-22 — draft2 finding	Independent re-check for any new vessel strike, seizure, or Iran-related military incident, Aug 19-22
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed without a signed deal; Iran says the US breached it first, Trump says "no time schedule" (softened Aug 19)
Fired Aug 17, logged Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, new target named	Trump threatened Oman ("we'd handle them very easily") if it "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait
Reported Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative	Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed to 3-5 weekend transits vs. 31 the prior weekend vs. ~110/day pre-war baseline (re-checked; see The Facts)
Fired Aug 18, logged Aug 20 — negative, isolated so far	A commercial vessel struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait, engine damage, one crew injury
Fired Aug 14-15, logged Aug 16 — continuation, now compounding	Three ADNOC tanker incidents (two Aug 14, one Aug 15) — no injuries, UAE/IRGC attribution, no direct Iranian claim
Reported Aug 13 — continuation, not escalation	Hormuz deal remains unsigned; both sides' compensation demands harden (Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, The Hill) — Brent close low
Fired Aug 11, logged Aug 12 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi "double-tap" strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah (Bab al-Mandeb Strait, Red Sea) — 6 killed
Fired Aug 9, found Aug 11 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery (400,000 bpd) — no injuries, fire extinguished same-day
Reported Aug 8-9 — continuation, not escalation	Iranian FM Araqchi calls the Oman deal "very close" but adds a US-compensation demand; UAE reports another ship hit; Oman condemns "repeated attacks"
Jul 31 - Aug 5 — CONFIRMED, negative, missed by daily checks	Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents (Gaslog Shanghai, Oman-side explosion, Minoan Pioneer, two Kumzar explosions) — IMO tally now 6
Fired Aug 7 — CONFIRMED, negative, new front	Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia, wounding 11 civilians — the conflict's first widening to a fourth state
Pending — the real trigger	Whether a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both Iran and the US can accept is actually signed AND holds through a full week without a new event
Structural, ongoing	Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance plus the new Aug 7 Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact
By Dec 31, 2026	Final US–Iran nuclear deal signed — not fired, pending

The flip line, re-leveled — TRIGGERED Aug 30, and as of Sept 11 a SECOND distinct clause (sustained Brent close above \$100) has now ALSO fired: a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of direct strikes on Iran, or a confirmed US casualty. **As of Aug 30, the "resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" clause fired** — CENTCOM struck Larak Island, the first acknowledged US strike on Iran above \$100, including a close above \$107 on Sept 10, its highest since May 19. Two of the four clauses are now live; the remaining two (a confirmed new US combat death, a widening to a further new state with confirmed attribution, or a confirmed US casualty) are pending. The flip line is now nearly 100 targets struck (~50x Aug 30) plus the war's first direct strikes on Iranian government tankers — but none of the OTHER three clauses has independently fired fresh: the "confirmed new US combat death" clause is pending, the "widening to a further new state with confirmed attribution" clause is pending, and the "confirmed US casualty" clause is pending. Iran's Sept 2 retaliation hitting four countries simultaneously (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — every one of the four is a REPEAT target already struck earlier in this war, so "further new state with confirmed attribution" is not a new state. The flip line is nonetheless the largest single-cycle escalation since the flip line itself fired, which is why P moved sharply down that cycle. **UPDATE, Sept 6:** CENTCOM has now confirmed the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had with confirmed attribution. Neither independently re-fires any of the three unfired clauses (no confirmed US casualty, no confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, Brent short of \$100) — the cut this cycle is modest (no window moved > 1 point) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. **The equivalent upside flip: a signed Hormuz agreement the US actually accepts that holds past a full week without a new shipping attack, fatality, or seizure.** Oman's offer is a long way from an accepted deal considerably further away, not closer. Watch next cycle for: whether Sept 6's IRGC claims are independently confirmed, whether either side's threatened "much larger"/"significantly larger" response is accepted, or any of which would independently fire a fresh flip-line clause and likely warrant a larger cut. **UPDATE, Sept 8:** Iran's SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced intent to declare a "restricted zone" from the US Navy's 20th Fleet's independent outlets, but explicitly not yet executed (no boundaries announced, no confirmed incident tied to it). This does not independently re-fire any of the three unfired clauses (no confirmed US casualty, no confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, Brent short of \$100) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. **UPDATE, Sept 9:** CENTCOM confirms a FIVE-tanker strike Sept 8 (M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco, M/T Derya) in retaliation for the Sept 7 tanker strike. Neither of those clauses fires. Brent crosses \$100/bbl intraday for the first time since July 24 (~\$100.44) — the closest this cycle has come to the "sustained Brent >\$100" clause, but an intraday cross is explicitly not a confirmed US combat death, or a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state. **UPDATE, Sept 10:** the IRGC retaliates for the Sept 8 tanker strike by firing 20 missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq base — Jordan is a repeat target at the Bab al-Mandeb — a second chokepoint, but the same actor/theater already priced, and no strait closure has actually been confirmed, so this doesn't fire a clause either. Brent now trades above \$100 for a second straight session, short of a clean multi-session sustained call. None of the three unfired clauses independently re-fires this cycle — the cut is modest (no window moved > 1 point) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. (Perim) Island inside Bab al-Mandeb itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island (6+ independent outlets), and Brent has held a fifth straight session near/above \$104. Still, no strait CLOSURE or shipping interdiction has been confirmed, so that clause doesn't fire either — this is a severity escalation within the already-fired sustained-Brent and direct-strikes clauses, not a fresh clause. The cut is moderate (no window moved > 2 points) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. (Perim) Island inside Bab al-Mandeb (vs. merely holding its shores/islands), whether Zuqar Island's contested status resolves, a confirmed US combat death, or a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state. **UPDATE, Sept 12 (final update):** the US confirmed a confirmed US casualty on Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement Sept 11) — does not independently fire either the widening clause (Iraq is existing theater, active since the Sept 1 Erbil strike) or the US-casualty clause (none confirmed); so the flip line is not a new state > 1 point) and, because this is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, is LEFT AS DRAFT for Alex's manual review regardless of the move's size — full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority. The flip line is close or interdict shipping through Bab al-Mandeb, a confirmed US combat death, or a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state.

My Decision

COMMITTED — SEPTEMBER 17, 2026 (2026-09-17_draft) · LIGHT DAILY TOUCH · AUTO-STAMPED · THIS PILLAR HELD FLAT

P (2026-09-17_draft, COMMITTED — light daily touch, auto-stamped; HELD FLAT): 1 / 1 / 14 / 33 / 66 · Prior committed P (2026-09-16_draft, li pillar's signals (all unchanged): 1mo -4.70 · 3mo -5.10 · 6mo -4.03 (Strong Bear) · 1yr -1.77 (Bear) · 3yr +1.41 (Mild Bull) · Master (equal-weight) NUMBER: -0.13 equal-weight (Neutral) / +0.42 horizon-weighted (Neutral) — versus -0.05 / +0.53 on the cloud routine's own committed Sept corrected to 32/30/38/44/58 after the FOMC's projections table put the end-2027 median federal funds rate at 4.1%, up from 3.6% in June. TI

Sept 14 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-15_draft), this version — yesterday's up-move is retraced, because the meeting it rested on was called off: the Salalah ministerial never convened. C constructive dialogue," with **no replacement date** — corroborated across Arab News, the Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News and Malay Mail. Bahrain had ruled out attending, no GCC state had confirmed, **not used to move P**. FM Araqchi separately said the Iran-Oman understanding "would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz." Brent pushed past \$107 (+2.8%) on the news — a market price, reports touch, research access was full, and Step 6 verification passed clean — so per the runbook's delegated auto-stamp authority this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped escalation read faster than it retraced).

Sept 13 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-13_draft), prior cycle — the first UPWARD re-rate on this pillar since August 6, now superseded by the postponement above: ONE sufficiency-clear **11 that the foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and Iraq will convene in Salalah, Oman on Monday Sept 14 to discuss navigation through the Strait of Hormuz** — specifically safe and tem mediated Iran-Oman talks. This is the first time high-level officials from Iran and the six GCC states have gathered in one place since the war began in February. PRIMARY: the Iranian MFA's own statement, shared regional security." Corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera Sept 11, Dawn Sept 12, Arab News, Oman Observer, The Business Standard, Business Recorder, ARMENPRESS, SBS) — comfort **points and not a reversal:** (1) Bahrain announced Sept 12 it will NOT attend, so GCC participation is incomplete; (2) an Iranian official told the Jerusalem Post that NO signed Hormuz deal is expected out controls, with Tehran weighing a service-fee regime for transiting vessels, which arguably institutionalises rather than lifts the blockade; (4) the kinetic war did not pause — on Sept 13 a commercial vessel w that attribution is Iran's own and is logged, NOT treated as established), a Houthi projectile struck Jazan in Saudi Arabia causing injuries and damaging a mosque, and Houthi forces continued trading strikes **reported as a market price and NOT used to move P:** Brent gave back 4.24% on Friday Sept 11 to ~\$104.26 — the first meaningful downside session since the sustained->\$100 flip-line clause fired — at **direction.** The downside clauses already fired (direct US strikes on Iran proper, Aug 30; sustained Brent close above \$100, Sept 10-11) remain fired and continue to hold — Brent is still above \$100. The ups An announced meeting at which no deal is expected is not that. **P RE-RATED UP, modestly, to 3/3/19/39/70** (from 1/1/17/37/70) — 1mo +2, 3mo +2, 6mo +2, 12mo +2, 36mo held at 70 (one announced sits, and is sized symmetrically against the 1-to-2-point daily cuts this pillar has been taking all month. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is an ordinary light daily touch, research capability (WebSearch/WebFetch, and verification reconciled clean. Per the runbook's delegated auto-stamp authority — widened Sept 2 so that move size, call-band movement, and how novel the news feels are no longer grounds to withhold change that test: the same rules that justified six weeks of downward re-rates justify this upward one.

Sept 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12_draft2), prior version — still DRAFT, awaiting Alex's manual review: four parallel adversarial research passes ran across all four qualitative pillars Fed & Macro each held flat on independent re-check (see those reports). Iran War Risk found ONE sufficiency-clearing new fact beyond the morning baseline: **Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline statement/confirmation Sept 11),** a new target distinct from the already-logged Sept 8 Aramco/Jazan refinery strikes. PRIMARY: Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping station corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com), with satellite imagery of fire/smoke at the pumping stations, plus Iraq's own PM ordering group has claimed responsibility, and the Saudi MFA statement attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state; President Trump, in Dublin, called Iran "probably" responsible — a SINGLE, HE (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province — this is escalation within an existing theater, not a new one); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (no confirm baseline) as persistence, not a fresh trigger. Also logged, not scored: Trump's own account that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen (single-source as to substance 12, all members plus Saudi Arabia, Iran, and UAE) urging "maximum restraint" — a mild, long-horizon diplomatic data point (1yr/3yr framing only). The Mayyun Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure was independent **DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held, 1mo held at the near-floor 1. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, not a light move size or how the sufficiency rule was applied. **This set is LEFT AS DRAFT: status draft, NOT stamped, flagged prominently for Alex's manual review.**

Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft), prior cycle: the load-bearing development is that Houthi forces, an Iran-aligned proxy, have moved from "closing in on" to actual island-level 10, Houthi forces captured Dhubab and Murad (the last government-held coastal towns) by Sept 11, giving them Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline, and separately seized Mayyun (Perim) Island in the strait National, National Herald). Saudi Crown Prince MBS's request for direct US strikes on the Houthis was refused, with intelligence/targeting support offered instead — a genuine US-restraint counterweight, I an IRGC claim of a Sairdron strike is single-source and not used to move P. Brent held near/above \$104 for a fifth straight session, confirming persistence of the flip-line clause that already fired, not a fresh already-fired flip-line environment, not a new flip-line event, but is a bigger step than the routine daily grind. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/2/18/38/70** — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 4-2, 6mo 20-18 (throughout), and verification passed clean — under the runbook's widened delegated authority, neither the size of a move nor the severity of the underlying news is by itself a reason to withhold the stamp. Macro all held flat on independent re-check — see those reports.

Sept 11 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-11_draft), prior cycle: the load-bearing development is that this pillar's own **"sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause has FIRED.** Brent ended 19 — with WTI closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent), and Brent was still ~\$104.36 midday Friday confirmed closes and one decisively so; the two prior cycles called this a near-miss and explicitly flagged it for watching, and the honest reading now is that it fired. *Correction to the prior cycle:* the Sept 10 shipping wave: Iran attacked 10 vessels near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), the largest declared wave of the war, with at least one seafarer killed and one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, For further new state was struck, so the widening clause does not fire either. Logged but not used to move P: a single compilation putting Hormuz throughput at 7 transits Sept 9 vs a Kpler 10-day average of 1 contraction forecast. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/4/20/40/71** — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 5-4, 6mo 22-20, 12mo 42-40, 36mo 72-71. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is an ordinary light daily touch, runbook's widened delegated authority, neither the size of a move nor the drama of a flip-line clause firing is by itself a reason to withhold the stamp. **This set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped** modestly after the August CPI print landed mid-cycle with core a tenth cooler than consensus — see those reports.

Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft), prior cycle: two new dated facts since the Sept 9 baseline. (1) CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera Sept 9, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, corroborating Jordan's own military statement). Jordan is a repeat target (struck previously Aug 30-31), so the wide also does not fire (US KIA count remains 18, unchanged since Sept 4 per GlobalSecurity's own tracker — a separate low-quality aggregator claiming a fresh KIA figure was checked and rejected as uncorro Mocha on Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a SECOND global shipping chokepoint distinct from Hormuz — confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel actor and theater already priced (not a strike on a further new state), and no strait closure or shipping interdiction has actually been confirmed yet — outlets describe Houthis as "closing in on" and "threaten has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session (CNBC: Brent above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9 for the first time since May; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Thursday Sept 10) — more persistence standard; flagged as the closest this cycle has come, and worth close watching next cycle, but does not independently fire that clause. Net: a repeat-pattern regional strike plus a new-but-same-actor Yeme 3mo/6mo/12mo only (-1 point each: 6-5, 23-22, 43-42); 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room) and 36mo held flat at 72 (a repeat regional strike and a same-theater territorial shift do not move master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip (Neutral-Neutral equal-weight, Mild Bull-Mild Bull horizon-weighted) — so per the runbook's delegated auto-stamp authority this set is **AUTO-STAMPED:**

Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09_draft), prior cycle: CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship," centcom.mil) confirms U Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days. Corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News Iranian missile attempts were evaded and no US personnel were harmed — the confirmed-US-casualty flip-line clause remains unfired — and Gulf of Oman/Kharg Island are both existing theater, so the wide crossed \$100/bbl intraday today (Sept 9) for the first time since July 24 — confirmed by CNBC ("Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries") and ABC News, trading ~\$100. this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" threshold, so it does not independently fire that clause either. Iran's Sept 6-7 SNSC "restricted zone" announcement remains in the same not-yet-executed state as continuation and intensification of the same escalation trend the Sept 6/8 cycles already priced, not a fresh flip-line event. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 7-6, 6mo 25-24, 12mo 72-71** and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped**

Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08_draft), prior cycle: Iran's SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced on-record (Iranian state TV, carried by Press TV and Tehran Times), Sept 6-7, that 10 days," with any vessel entering it placed on Iran's sanctions list; he separately said an Iran-Oman corridor agreement would be signed "in the coming days." Corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera sufficiency bar. This is a genuine new escalatory signal but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed: Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer states "further details, including the precise boundaries, have y independently fire: DCAS US KIA remains 18 (unchanged since Sept 4), no widening to a further new state, and Brent closed ~\$97.29/bbl Sept 7 (tradingeconomics.com) — still short of \$100. GlobalSecurity of the already-priced trend, not scored separately. No permanent Iran-Oman corridor deal has been signed. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 8-7, 6mo 25-24, 12mo 72-71** and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped**

Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft), prior cycle: CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil) now confirms the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had explicitly withheld from oil tankers on Sept 5 — M/T Downy (permanently disabled off Kharg Island), M/T Stark 1 (permanently disabled near Jask), and M/T Kylo (completely destroyed in the Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the American personnel were harmed. Corroborated by Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC, and 5+ other independent outlets in addition to CENTCOM's own release — this clears the sufficiency bar the Sept 5 tanker interdiction. Separately, Sept 6 (today) brings further IRGC claims — three more tankers, three "US-linked" vessels, and a US naval drone struck in the Strait (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) — which a independently fire: DCAS still shows 18 confirmed US deaths (unchanged since Sept 4), Kharg Island/Jask/Gulf of Oman are all existing theater (not a new state), and Brent closed ~\$96/bbl Friday Sept 4 (m

27→25, 12mo 47→45, 36mo 74→73. No window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar (CENTCOM's own release), and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-w price comparison) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Sept 3-5 re-check, held flat: Iran fired a second retaliatory wave Sept 3 on Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE) — a US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit and no third night clause still does not fire. Brent held roughly flat (~\$95.2-95.75 Sept 4), still short of \$100. Two developments logged, NOT used to move P: (1) Reuters shared images/video with four independent weapons fragments identified) — this upgrades the casualty claim's sourcing from single-narrative to independently corroborated by a primary Western wire service, but the US has still not accepted responsibility (V PRICED Sept 1-2 event rather than describing new escalation, so it does not independently move P; (2) Sept 5 (today, developing): Iranian state/semi-official media (Fars) reported four missiles struck an Iranian confirmation as of this research pass, so per the sufficiency rule this single-narrative claim is NOT used to move P. WATCH NEXT CYCLE: if independently confirmed, this would be a materially new escalation warned the US that an Israeli move on Lebanon's Ali al-Taher ridge would trigger a "large-scale attack" on Israel; the IDF took the ridge Sept 3, but no such attack has been confirmed as of this run — a live STAMPED SEPTEMBER 5, 2026," but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced to committed — a bug in that session, flagged here and not corrected retroactively.

Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2), this version: independently re-verified via WebSearch. The Sept 5 tanker report has firmed up considerably since the daily touch a few hours earlier: the Tasnim (Iranian state media); separately, Iran International — a London-based Persian broadcaster editorially independent of and adversarial to Tehran — obtained video of three US radio warnings ordering an incident is headlined "Iran accuses the US of targeting a tanker" — treating it as an accusation, not a confirmed fact — and US Central Command had not issued any statement confirming or denying this. Curacao-flagged M/T Belma was disabled via Hellfire-into-smokestack after ignoring warnings — that precedent is already priced in). Per the sufficiency rule, the identity of the striking party still needs either fact; Iran International's video corroborates that warnings were issued and a strike occurred, but does not independently confirm US authorship versus Iran's own narrative — so this is NOT used to move P. None of the pillar's flip-line clauses independently fired this week regardless: no confirmed new US combat death (standing count remains 18 per GlobalSecurity Day 189), no widening to a further new state escalation but still short of the \$100 sustained-flip threshold. **P HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy regardless**

This is a light daily catch-up against the Sept 1 baseline (7/15/32/50/75, auto-stamped) — but it turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since the flip line itself fired Aug 30. **The load-bearing new fact** in scale of the single Aug 30 Larak Island strike — including, for the first time in this war, direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy. A US strike on Kuwait (injured) — CENTCOM has neither confirmed nor denied it, and this claim is explicitly flagged single-narrative-sourced at the core fact level, so it is NOT itself used to move P. It is reported as context for Iraq, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — all repeat targets, so the widening-to-a-new-state flip-line clause does not fire. Multi-source corroborated: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI, Al Jazeera, Yahoo, CBS News, RFE/RL

P RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY: 1mo 7→1, 3mo 15→9, 6mo 32→27, 12mo 50→47, 36mo 75→74. Every window moved under 8 points, but this is the largest front-loaded cut since the Aug 30-31 flip-line genuinely new state, Brent short of \$100), but the already-fired "resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" clause is escalating sharply in scale, which is what's driving the size of this move.

Still a **dip-watching pillar, not a panic-selling one** — the four-country retaliation hit repeat targets, most projectiles were intercepted, and no US casualty is confirmed. But the trajectory since Aug 30 is not responses. A confirmed new US combat death, a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, or Brent sustaining a close above \$100 would each independently warrant a further, larger cut.

Why this was originally left as a draft Sept 2, pending manual review: (1) the core wedding-casualty fact — the emotional and political driver of that day's four-country retaliation — is single-narrative-sourced primary event, and this pillar's own research chose not to self-approve a cut resting partly on it; (2) the jump in scale — nearly 100 targets and the war's first-ever direct tanker strikes, versus two rocket cover; (3) both sides were on-record threatening much larger responses ahead ("significantly larger" from Trump, "many times greater" from an Iranian military source), raising the cost of a miscalibrated cut — under the rules in force that day, this alone disqualified the set from delegated daily auto-stamp.

September 3, 2026 update: Alex reviewed this cycle's research (delivered as PDFs Sept 2) and widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy in CLAUDE.md: a call-band flip and the size of a move are no longer verification inconsistency. This cycle had neither: the research was multi-sourced, and the single-narrative wedding-casualty claim was correctly kept out of the P move under the sufficiency rule. Nothing at STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026.

Historical note: the paragraph above was the Sept 2 cycle's original manual-review flag, superseded by the Sept 3 auto-stamp policy widening and, again, by this cycle's own auto-stamp. Left here for the audit trail.

What Changed Since Last Check

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 17, 2026 (score set **2026-09-17_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-16_draft committed baseline (1/1/14/33/66). **This pillar HELD FLAT.**

- **Re-checked for a new dated development beyond the Sept 9 IAEA referral and the Sept 12-13 NPT-withdrawal statement — found none.** Pezeshkian's public no-nuclear-weapons statement confirmed this cycle. No new development found on the Salalah ministerial, the Saudi pipeline repair timeline, or Hormuz shipping.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.** No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 16 light daily touch (2026-09-16_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 16, 2026 (score set **2026-09-16_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-15_draft committed baseline (1/1/18/38/70). **This pillar RE-RATED DOWN on the 6/12**

- ★ ★ **NEW — the IAEA Board of Governors voted Sept 9, 2026 to refer Iran's nuclear file to the UN Security Council** — a primary institutional escalation not previously priced by this pillar.
- ★ ★ **NEW — 130 Iranian lawmakers signed a statement Sept 12-13, 2026 calling on parliament to begin the legal process for NPT withdrawal**, with a headline MP saying an emergency session would be called.
- **Counterweight, logged:** President Pezeshkian publicly reiterated Iran is not seeking nuclear weapons; the Foreign Ministry says the withdrawal bill "is still being prepared" — a real step, not a rhetorical flourish.
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, 1/1/18/38/70 → 1/1/14/33/66.** 1mo/3mo held at the floor (no room to move further); 6mo 18→14, 12mo 38→33, 36mo 70→66.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 15 light daily touch (2026-09-15_draft, committed, auto-stamped, held flat), for continuity:

- **The Salalah ministerial remains postponed with no new date** — the fact that drove yesterday's re-rate down, unchanged. Al Jazeera (Sept 14) adds detail already consistent with what was reported; Omani FM Albusaidi gave no new date and no reason beyond "in the interests of consensus."
- **Saudi Arabia's East-West (Petroline) pipeline is still offline** — already priced Sept 12. Saudi energy-ministry sources put the loss at roughly **700,000 barrels a day**; Aramco has not said how much is lost, and the pipeline remains **unconfirmed by Aramco or the Ministry of Energy — reported, not scored.**
- **INTERESTED-PARTY CLAIM, reported not scored:** Bloomberg (Sept 14) reports an *Iranian claim* that a tanker struck mines in the Strait of Hormuz. Uncorroborated by any independent party; the claim is a mildly de-escalatory datapoint, also single-sourced and not scored.
- **MARKET PRICES, reported not scored:** Brent closed above **\$105** and WTI rose toward **\$102** (Sept 14–15), slightly below yesterday's ~\$108 Brent print. Still inside the already-fired "sustained reopening, and the downside direct-US-strikes clause is unfired.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/18/38/70.** No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 14 light daily touch (2026-09-14_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 14, 2026 (score set **2026-09-14_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-13_draft committed baseline (3/3/19/39/70).

- ★ ★ **NEW — the Salalah ministerial did not happen. Oman postponed it on Sunday, September 13, with no new date.** PRIMARY: Oman News Agency — "It has been decided to postpone the ministerial meeting to allow for constructive dialogue." Corroborated independently by Arab News, the Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News and Malay Mail (Sept 13-14). This is the exact fact yesterday's upward re-rate was based on.
- **The problem is Gulf-Arab buy-in, not the calendar. Bahrain explicitly ruled out attending; no GCC state had confirmed participation** before the postponement; and the **UAE had already ruled out attending** — evidence of de-escalation than a meeting announced.
- **Iran says Saudi Arabia asked for the delay, citing the Yemen war, and calls that a pretext — SINGLE-PARTY SOURCED and NOT used to move P.** This is Iran's MFA spokesman characterizing Albusaidi posted on X that Oman remains "determined to promote dialogue that contributes to stability and lasting cooperation in our region."
- **FM Araqchi capped the value of what survives: the Iran-Oman understanding "would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz"** (Tehran Times / Mehr News, Sept 13 — Iranian state media; also reported by the Guardian). He also confirmed the bilateral technical work is real: navigational charts drawn, draft joint statement prepared. That framework survives the postponement — which is why the 1-y
- **Market reaction — a MARKET PRICE, reported and not scored:** Brent crude pushed past **\$107/bbl (+2.8%, \$107.54 November delivery)** and WTI to **\$102.34 (+2.3%)** on the postponement.

- **Checked and REJECTED as stale:** research this cycle surfaced drone strikes on Oman's Salalah and Duqm ports, which would have been materially escalatory. Those incidents are dated **March 2026** without dates.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/1/18/38/70** (from 3/3/19/39/70) — 1mo -2 (the one near-term de-escalation catalyst evaporated with no replacement date) · 3mo -2 (the GCC re-evaluated the surviving Iran-Oman bilateral framework) · 36mo flat (nothing structural moved). Ordinary light daily touch, full research access, verification clean — **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated authority.

Carried forward — the September 13 light daily touch, for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 13, 2026 (score set 2026-09-13_draft, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-12_draft2 full weekly refresh (still draft, awaiting Alex's manual review).

- ★ **★ NEW — and for the first time since August 6, it cuts the other way: Iran's foreign ministry announced Friday Sept 11 that the foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and Iran's neighbors** will suspend commercial shipping routes, mine clearance, and short-term management of the waterway, built on weeks of Oman-mediated Iran-Oman talks. This is the first time high-level Iranian and GCC officials showed a better understanding among the countries of the region and help strengthen shared regional security"; corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera Sept 11, Dawn Sept 12, Arab News Sept 13).
- **Counterweight 1 — incomplete participation:** Bahrain announced Sept 12 that it will not attend the Oman meeting.
- **Counterweight 2 — no outcome expected:** an Iranian official told the Jerusalem Post that no signed Hormuz deal is expected out of Monday's meeting. This is a convening, not a settlement.
- **Counterweight 3 — what is actually being negotiated:** the agenda concerns *managing* transit through a strait Iran still controls, with Tehran weighing a service-fee regime for transiting vessels.
- **Counterweight 4 — the fighting did not pause.** Sept 13: a commercial vessel was attacked near Qeshm Island inside Hormuz, killing one and wounding four (an Iranian official blamed the Houthis for causing injuries and damaging a mosque; Houthi forces and Yemen's internationally recognised government continued trading strikes over Bab al-Mandeb (Al Jazeera live blog, Sept 13).
- **Market corroboration, reported NOT scored:** Brent gave back 4.24% Friday Sept 11 to ~\$104.26 — the first meaningful downside session since the sustained->\$100 clause fired — attributed to a "technical correction".
- **No flip-line clause fires in either direction.** The two fired downside clauses (direct US strikes on Iran proper, Aug 30; sustained Brent close above \$100, Sept 10-11) both remain fired and confirmed. The meeting with no deal expected is not that.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED UP, modestly, to 3/3/19/39/70** (from 1/1/17/37/70) — 1mo/3mo/6mo/12mo +2 each, 36mo held flat at 70. Concentrated on the near windows where the meeting was **committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)"** — an ordinary light daily touch with full research capability, clean verification, and sourcing well above the sufficiency bar. The direction of the score change is modestly positive.

Previous entry — FULL WEEKLY refresh, September 12, 2026 (score set 2026-09-12_draft2, still draft) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-12_draft committed baseline.

- ★ **★ NEW — a third distinct Saudi oil-infrastructure strike this week: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline), the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass export route, hit by drone strikes** on Sept 11, 2026, according to multiple outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com); Iraq's PM ordered a probe, dismissed the Maysan operations commander, and closed the Shalamcheh border crossing.
- **Attribution caveat:** no group has claimed responsibility; Trump's Dublin remark that Iran is "probably" responsible is a single, hedged, unconfirmed statement, not treated as fact.
- **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq already an active theater since the Sept 1 Erbil strike); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (none confirmed).
- **Logged, not scored:** the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12) urging "maximum restraint," and Trump's account of a private Houthi restraint signal on Yemen — both counterweighting the escalation.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held flat. **This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh** categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size).

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **★ NEW — a second global oil chokepoint moves from "under threat" to under adversary-aligned control.** Houthi forces, having seized Mocha Sept 10, captured Dhubab and Murad on the Red Sea coastline, and separately seized Mayyun (Perim) Island inside the Bab al-Mandeb strait, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Geographic).
- **Logged, honest counterweight:** Saudi Crown Prince MBS twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused (intelligence/targeting support offered instead).
- ★ **★ NEW — UKMTO Warning 133-26 confirms four projectiles struck two more vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman Sept 10, one set afire** (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborated).
- **Logged, not scored (single-source):** IRGC's own claim of a strike on a US Navy Saildrone near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM confirmation found.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from 1/4/20/40/71) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. Neither the widening clause nor the US-casualty clause fired in this environment, sized moderately larger than the routine 1-point daily touches given the scale of the underlying news. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **★ NEW — Houthi forces launched a significant ballistic-missile-and-drone attack directly on Saudi Arabian soil Sept 8, hitting Saudi Aramco energy facilities — including the 400,000 bbl/d Mithqal refinery** — several energy facilities and utilities temporarily halted; Saudi authorities confirmed 73 wounded (NPR, NBC News, Bloomberg, The Times of Israel, US News, Al Jazeera, The Daily Caller, SRN News). This is materially more severe than prior Saudi-linked incidents.
- ★ **★ NEW — Brent crude closes above \$100/bbl for a THIRD consecutive session, moving decisively to \$105.71-\$108** — the highest since May 19 (Reuters-linked wires, Bloomberg, Energy Intelligence, Wall Street Journal, exchanges — the closest this war has come to a sustained >\$100 close, still not formally called fired).
- ★ **★ NEW — the IAEA Board of Governors votes 23-3-8 Sept 9 to refer Iran to the UN Security Council over nuclear non-proliferation breaches** — the first such referral in two decades (Iran's Ali Akbar Salehi threatens on-record retaliation Sept 11, single-source, not used to move P).
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, larger than the recent 1-point touches, to 1/3/19/38/69** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -3, 12mo -4, 36mo -3 (the widening clause formally sustained close). No window moved more than 4 points, master call band unchanged everywhere — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base Sept 9, retaliating for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike.** Jordan's armed forces confirmed the attack (in its own military statement). Jordan is a repeat target — the widening clause does not fire; no casualties on either side — the US-casualty clause does not fire either.
- ★ **Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait**, a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz (The Media Line, Reuters, Al Jazeera, the strait closure actually confirmed).
- **Brent crude traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session** (above \$101 Sept 9, ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, but still short of a sustained close.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -1, 12mo -1, 36mo held flat. No flip-line clause independent. The widening window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Khasab)** — Corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets US Navy Ship").
- **Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24**, trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) on U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strike fears (CNBC, ABC News) — the closest that cycle had come to a sustained close.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces on-record, Sept 6-7, that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning** any further attacks (WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to Iranian state media (Press TV, Tehran Times) — clears the sufficiency bar.
- **This is a threat of intent, not yet executed:** Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer says boundaries have yet to be announced; no zone has actually been declared. A parallel claim of an imminent attack is also present.

★ **CENTCOM's own press release confirmed the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had withheld: THREE Iranian tankers struck (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) in retaliation for an IR**
outlets. Both US ships evaded, no American personnel harmed.

- ★ ★ NEW — Iran fired a second retaliatory wave Sept 3 on Kuwait and UAE, both REPEAT targets. A US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit; the widening-to-a-new-state claim is unconfirmed. (indep)
- ★ ★ NEW — Sept 5: the Iranian-flagged NITC tanker STARK 1 reportedly hit by four missiles ~6nm off Kharg Island. Iran's Tasnim (state media) makes the claim; Iran International (indep) accuses the US of targeting a tanker" (an accusation, not a confirmed fact); CENTCOM has not confirmed or denied it. NOT used to move P per the sufficiency rule — WATCH NEXT CYCLE.

- **Aug 17/18/20 drafts (never delivered):** held flat, then cut to 17/25/38/54/76, then cut further to 16/24/38/54/76 on the lapsed MoU window and the UAE missile claim (framed as a "novel" evidence).
- **Aug 21 (partially delivered, then abandoned):** a session began delivering the Aug 20 draft's numbers but updated only 2 of 6 reports and never ran render/selfcheck/archive/commit — treacherous.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — a fatal strike in the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign,** Aug 17-18: bulker Minoan Dignity's chief engineer killed, 7+ independent sources. That draft first (wrongly) surfaced before.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22,** the tanker Amara, boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17, still detained Aug 19. Confirmed accurate on adversarial re-check.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — CORRECTION: the UAE missile claim is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE** as prior drafts framed it; UAE was hit in April and at Fujairah May 4. The "novel evidence" claim was dropped.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle (draft2) — casualty toll re-verified as a range, not a point figure.** Second dedicated adversarial pass cross-checked Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (100% accurate, but not clean Hormuz) — honest toll is a **15-19 range (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**. This softens the morning draft's "roughly the 18th" framing, which was more precise than the baseline.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle (draft2) — the UAE missile claim reconciles to one episode, not two.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing the incident was confirmed on reconciliation to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline.
- **★ NEW this cycle (draft2) — no new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22** on independent re-checking; CENTCOM's blockade tally continues climbing incrementally (68 vessels redirected, vs. 60 in the baseline) — straight weekly gain, still under the \$100 flip line.
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes since Aug 1; sanctions remain mostly rhetoric** (one narrow OFAC-adjacent Hezbollah designation Aug 22, not the promised Iran-economy package); Iran said to be "in the process" of a deal.
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 (Aug 22)** — +7.4% vs. the Aug 20 close of \$71,882.92, a further move against the direction of this pillar's own evidence — logged as an honesty check (The Claim), not a "novel" evidence.
- **Score decision (draft2):** versus the Aug 16 committed baseline: 1mo 20 → **14** · 3mo 28 → **22** · 6mo 41 → **38** · 12mo 56 → **54** · 36mo 77 → **76** — unchanged from the Aug 22 morning draft; Houthi attacks (no authority); **COMMITTED BY ALEX August 23, 2026** after review. See My Decision for the full reasoning.

September 14 LIGHT DAILY touch (this cycle): **State News Agency (ONA)** — state news agency statement, **Sunday Sept 13, 2026: The Salah regional meeting is "postponed to a later date ... in order to ensure** commitment to regional dialogue (primary) · Arab News, "Oman says Hormuz talks with Iran, Gulf states postponed" (Sept 13) · The Washington Post, "Oman postpones regional talks on Strait of Hormuz" (Sept 13) · CNN, "Oman postpones GCC-Iran meeting on Strait of Hormuz as oil prices rise on supply fears" (Sept 13-14); also the source for Iran's MFA spokesman attributing the delay to a Saudi request — *single-party-sourced, reported not confirmed* · Times / Mehr News, "FM Araqchi: Oman understanding not enough to reopen Hormuz" (Sept 13 — Iranian state media quoting Iran's own FM; primary for Iran's stated position, not for facts it asserts about others) · Euronews, "Iran Times of Israel and Gulf News reporting on drone strikes at Salalah and Duqm ports — those are dated March 1/3/11, 2026, and are not part of this cycle.

• **September 13 LIGHT DAILY touch (prior cycle):** Iranian Ministry of Foreign Affairs — announcement (Friday Sept 11) that Iran will meet the GCC foreign ministers and Iraq in Salalah, Oman on Monday Sept 14 to discuss shared regional security" (primary) · Al Jazeera, "Iran says will discuss Strait of Hormuz with Gulf states on Monday," Sept 11 · Dawn, "Tehran agrees to engage Gulf states over Hormuz future," Sept 12 · Arab News · Oman's independent corroboration of the meeting, its date, its ministerial level, and its agenda (safe/temporary shipping routes, mine clearance, short-term management of the waterway) · Bahrain's Sept 12 announcement that that Iranian official says" — logged counterweight · Al Jazeera live blog, Sept 13 — commercial vessel attacked near Qeshm Island (1 killed, 4 wounded; Iran's attribution to the US logged as Iran's own, not established), Houthi reported as a market price and explicitly not used to move P.

• **September 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh (prior cycle):** Saudi Arabia's Ministry of Foreign Affairs — official statement confirming drone strikes on East-West Pipeline (Petroline) pumping stations near Riyadh/Medina, Sept 11 at the pumping stations near Al Mesba'ah and Al Dhekra · Iraqi PM's office (via corroborating outlets) — probe of the Maysan operations command, commander dismissed, Shalamchah border crossing closed · President's involvement in Yemen (single-source as to substance) · BRICS New Delhi summit — joint declaration, Sept 12, signed by all members plus Saudi Arabia, Iran, and UAE, urging "exercising maximum restraint" · Euronews, Al Jazeera · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$104.61 Sept 12, unchanged from the morning baseline.

• **September 12 light daily catch-up (prior, this morning):** Al Jazeera ("Can the Houthis close the Red Sea after seizing the Yemen coast?," Sept 11) — Houthi capture of the entire Red Sea coastline · NBC News, CNBC, NDTV, continuing for Zugar Island; Saudi Crown Prince MBS's request for US strikes on the Houthis refused · UKMTD Warning 133-26 (1910 UTC Sept 10, official) — four projectiles struck two vessels near Khasab, Oman, one of which was damaged · ~\$104.61 Sept 12, a fifth consecutive session near/above \$100 · GlobalSecurity.org, Iran War 2026 Day 196 (Sept 11) — IRGC claim of a Saildrone strike near the Strait entrance, no US confirmation found · local run.py query · ~\$104.61 Sept 12, a fifth consecutive session near/above \$100 · GlobalSecurity.org, Iran War 2026 Day 196 (Sept 11) — IRGC claim of a Saildrone strike near the Strait entrance, no US confirmation found · local run.py query

• **September 11 light daily catch-up:** Rigzone (Bloomberg wire, Sept 10) — Brent ended Thursday up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday, highest in nearly four months; WTI closed above \$102, a record · the IEA's 2.5 mb/d 2026 demand-contraction forecast as the counterweight · Vantage Markets, NAI500 (Sept 10) — corroborating Brent above \$100-102 on Hormuz strike risk · Reuters wire via U.S. News, "Iran attacks of the war; at least one seafarer killed, one missing · GlobalSecurity.org, Iran War 2026 Day 195 (Sept 10) — direct fetch returned HTTP 403 this cycle, so its content is cited only as surfacers in search summaries (filed for later)

• **September 10 light daily catch-up:** Al Jazeera (Sept 9), MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org (Iran War 2026 Day 194) — corroborating reporting on Jordan's own military statement confirming the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail — corroborating reporting on the Houthi seizure of the Yemeni port of Mocha, Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait · CNBC — Brent above \$100 (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged; a separate low-quality aggregator's claim of a fresh KIA figure checked and rejected as uncorroborated · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$77,993.99 (Sept 10)

• **September 9 light daily catch-up:** CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, "US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship" (Sept 8, primary source): M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Housh, reporting on the same CENTCOM statement and the two Iranian missile attempts on a US Navy warship, both evaded · CNBC — "Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries" (Sept 9) · ABC News, "Oil prices rise as U.S. and Iran clash" (Sept 9) · Reuters · Euronews · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$97.29/bbl Sept 9 close (US/UK markets closed Saturday Sept 9, no new print) · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7).

• **September 8 light daily catch-up:** Press TV, Tehran Times (Iranian state media) — Mohsen Rezaei's (SNSC secretary) on-record statement, Sept 6-7, announcing intent to declare a "restricted zone" from the US Navy's 1st Fleet · Iran enforce a restricted zone in the Strait of Hormuz?," Sept 7 explainer, noting boundaries not yet announced), The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency (aa.com.tr), Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org — corroborating reporting on the disabled, 2 boarded (vs. Day 190's 87/3/2, Sept 3) · standing DoD casualty records (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$97.29/bbl Sept 7 close · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7).

• **September 6 light daily catch-up:** CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, "CENTCOM Destroys 3 IRGC Oil Tankers After Iran Targets 2 U.S. Navy Warships" (Sept 5, primary source) · Al Arabiya English, Jerusalem Post, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) and the IRGC ballistic-missile attack on 2 US Navy warships · Al Jazeera live blog ("Iran war live: IRGC claims attacks on 3 oil tankers and 3 US-linked ships," Sept 6) and Euronews (Sept 6, Iranian for the attack (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged · TradingEconomics / multiple market-desk reports — Brent ~\$96/bbl Friday Sept 4 close (US/UK markets closed Saturday Sept 6, no new print) · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7).

• **September 3-5 re-check:** GlobalSecurity — Iran War 2026 Day 188-189 updates (Sept 3-4): Iran's second retaliatory wave hit Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE), both repeat targets; a US official confirmed the strikes (Nukta, Tribune, TBS News, unnn.ua) — four independent weapons experts' forensic analysis of images/video verified by Reuters, concluding the Sept 1 Kuhstak wedding strike was likely a direct hit by a US munition (USO, Reuters, Euronews, Al Jazeera, Iran's own media) · Iranian-media-only (Fars) report of a tanker strike near Kharg Island, unconfirmed by CENTCOM or any independent source · Critical Threats/ISW — Iran's warning that an Israeli move on Lebanon's Ali al-Taher ridge would trigger a "catastrophic" response · Reuters · Euronews · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$95.96/bbl Sept 3 close (US/UK markets closed Saturday Sept 3, no new print) · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7).

• **September 2 light daily catch-up — CENTCOM-confirmed strikes plus multi-source reporting on the retaliation:** Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI — corroborating reporting on the CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes on the first-ever direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy · Al Jazeera, CBS News, Yahoo, UPI — reporting on the Kuhstak, Hormozgan wedding-strike casualty toll (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged · TradingEconomics / multiple market-desk reports — Brent ~\$95.96/bbl Sept 3 close (US/UK markets closed Saturday Sept 3, no new print) · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7).

• **September 1 light daily catch-up — UKMTD log plus multi-source reporting:** UKMTD — Senegal Prosperity incident log, Aug 31 (VLCC struck by three unknown projectiles ~17nm NE of Khasab, Oman; port side, engine room damaged) · corroborating reporting on the Al Minhad Air Base drone-strike claim (Iran's army) and the UAE Ministry of Defense's on-record denial of the target claim plus confirmation of an intercepted Iranian drone over UAE territory (reported for us") · multiple market-desk reports (e.g. Bloomberg's Sept 1 oil roundup) — Brent ~+2% Tuesday Sept 1 on fresh-clash fears · Bitstamp — BTC \$78,038.78 (Sept 1) vs. \$78,447.16 (Aug 31).

• **August 31 light daily catch-up — on-record statement plus multi-source reporting:** CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Tim Hawkins (on the record, via Bloomberg/CNBC/Newsweek) — confirms the Aug 30 strike on the Iranian oil tanker "Al Fatah" (Aug 30) · CNBC — "U.S. strikes Iranian rocket launchers near Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 30) · NBC News — "U.S. forces strike Iranian rocket launchers... first military action in weeks" (Aug 30) · Reuters · Euronews, WLT Report (Aug 30, corroborating) · Korea Times, India TV News, RFE/RL — Iran's IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on King Hussein and Al-Azraq airbases, Jordan (Aug 31) · Jordan's military statement (via Fars) · Reuters · Euronews · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$95.96/bbl Sept 3 close (US/UK markets closed Saturday Sept 3, no new print) · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7).

• **August 29 full weekly refresh — direct primary-source adversarial fetches:** home.treasury.gov — press releases sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Regime on Economic D-Day") a US official (crypto-intelligence corroboration of the 30 BTC/ETH/TRON addresses listed, first-ever digital-assets sectoral designation) · law-firm trade-compliance client alerts (Aug 24-25) · fm.gov.om/en/53722 — Oman's own Foreign Ministry statement that the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance.

• **August 29 full weekly refresh — reporting and data:** UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedStar, IranWire (Aug 28) — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record mine-clearing/blockade briefing (Aug 28) · Reuters · Euronews · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$95.96/bbl Sept 3 close (US/UK markets closed Saturday Sept 3, no new print) · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7).

• **August 28 full weekly refresh — reporting and data:** UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedStar, IranWire (Aug 28) — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record mine-clearing/blockade briefing (Aug 28) · Reuters · Euronews · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$95.96/bbl Sept 3 close (US/UK markets closed Saturday Sept 3, no new print) · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7).

• **August 27 full weekly refresh — reporting and data:** UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedStar, IranWire (Aug 28) — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record mine-clearing/blockade briefing (Aug 28) · Reuters · Euronews · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$95.96/bbl Sept 3 close (US/UK markets closed Saturday Sept 3, no new print) · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7).

• **August 26 full weekly refresh — reporting and data:** UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedStar, IranWire (Aug 28) — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record mine-clearing/blockade briefing (Aug 28) · Reuters · Euronews · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$95.96/bbl Sept 3 close (US/UK markets closed Saturday Sept 3, no new print) · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7).

• **August 25 full weekly refresh — reporting and data:** UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedStar, IranWire (Aug 28) — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record mine-clearing/blockade briefing (Aug 28) · Reuters · Euronews · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$95.96/bbl Sept 3 close (US/UK markets closed Saturday Sept 3, no new print) · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.

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